24 Lessons for Children

LESSON 1

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

To attract Divine blessings and create a spiritual atmosphere, begin the class by reciting a prayer you know from memory, such as the one suggested in Section 2. You can then ask the children whether any of them know a prayer by heart that they could recite for the class. Afterwards, they will memorize the prayer below. To help them grasp its significance, identify any words you think may need to be explained with concrete examples. It is expected that many of the children will learn this one easily, but you should review it with them at the start of the next three class periods so that, by Lesson 5 when they begin to learn a new prayer, this one has become engraved on their hearts and minds.

"He is God! O God, my God! Bestow upon me a pure heart, like unto a pearl."[98]

Since the prayer the children will be memorizing in these first few lessons is short, you will have several opportunities to discuss with them some of the ideas mentioned in Section 2 about reverence and the nature of prayer.

B. Songs

After the period dedicated to prayers, the children can learn to sing the following song, which puts to music the quotation they will memorize later related to the theme of the lesson, purity of heart. Since some of the words may be difficult for the youngsters, you could help them learn to sing the first four lines, while you carry on with the rest.

My First Counsel

C C/B Am C/B
O Son of Spirit!

C C/B Am C/B
O Son of Spirit!

F G
My first counsel is this

F G
My first counsel is this

F G C Am
Possess a pure, kindly and radiant heart

F G C Am
That thine may be a sovereignty

F G C C/B Am C/B
Ancient, imperishable and everlasting

F G C
Ancient, imperishable

C. Memorizing quotations

As the next activity, the children will memorize a quotation from the Bahá'í Writings. You can introduce the theme of the lesson and the quotation for memorization in the following way:

> Our hearts are like mirrors. We should always keep them clean. Holding a grudge towards someone, feeling jealous of someone, and being unkind to anyone for whatever reason—these are like dust that cover the mirror of our hearts. When our hearts are pure, they reflect the light of God and His attributes—attributes such as kindness, love, and generosity—and we become a cause of happiness to others. To help keep our hearts pure, let us memorize this quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:
>
> **"O Son of Spirit! My first counsel is this: Possess a pure, kindly and radiant heart . . ."[99]**

The children will find the quotation easier to memorize if they understand it well. It is recommended, therefore, that you spend some time discussing the meaning of the words and phrases with them. Here are a few sentences that will assist you:

Counsel

1. One day Gerard and Mary were coloring some drawings. Gerard needed the yellow crayon, but Mary did not want to give it to him. The teacher told Mary that she should share. The teacher gave Mary good counsel.

2. Patricia has to decide whether to spend her money on candy or on a storybook. Her parents advise her to buy the storybook. Her parents give Patricia good counsel.

Possess

1. Tinaye likes to read prayers before going to sleep. She has a small prayer book to read from. Tinaye possesses a small prayer book.

2. We grow many delicious vegetables in our garden. We possess a good plot of land that gives us many fresh vegetables.

Pure heart

1. Cathy became angry and said unkind words to Agot. Agot was sad but quickly forgave Cathy. Agot possesses a pure heart.

2. Gustavo likes to share his cookies with all the children, even with Jorge, who does not share anything with others. Gustavo possesses a pure heart.

Kindly heart

1. When her parents invite friends to their home, Ming Ling happily serves them food. Ming Ling possesses a kindly heart.

2. Mr. Robertson is very old. Jimmy helps him carry his fruit harvest to the market. Jimmy possesses a kindly heart.

Radiant heart

1. When I feel sad, my mother always cheers me up and makes me happy. My mother possesses a radiant heart.

2. Obuya became ill and had to spend all his time in bed. He said many prayers, did not become sad, and continued to show forth happiness. Obuya possesses a radiant heart.

D. Story

Once the children have memorized the quotation, you can tell them the story below about ‘Abdu’l-Bahá that will demonstrate to them further the importance of purity of heart. Remember that, if some of the youngsters in your class are unfamiliar with ‘Abdu’l-Bahá, you should be prepared to say a few words about Him before you begin.

> *‘Abdu’l-Bahá could always tell what was in a person’s heart, and He greatly loved people whose hearts were pure and radiant. There was a lady who had the honor of being the guest of ‘Abdu’l-Bahá at dinner. As she sat listening to His words of wisdom, she looked at a glass of water in front of her and thought, “Oh! If only ‘Abdu’l-Bahá would take my heart and empty it of every earthly desire and then refill it with Divine love and understanding, just as you would do with this glass of water.”*
>
> *This thought passed through her mind quickly, and she did not say anything about it, but soon something happened that made her realize ‘Abdu’l-Bahá had known what she was thinking. While He was in the middle of His talk, He paused to call over an attendant and said a few words to him softly. The attendant quietly came to the lady’s place at the table, took her glass, emptied it, and put it back in front of her.*
>
> *A little later, ‘Abdu’l-Bahá, while continuing to talk, picked up a pitcher of water from the table, and in a most natural way, slowly refilled the lady’s empty glass. No one noticed what had happened, but the lady knew that ‘Abdu’l-Bahá was answering her heart’s desire. She was filled with joy. Now she knew that hearts and minds were like open books to ‘Abdu’l-Bahá, Who read them with great love and kindliness.*

E. Game: “Sharing”

For the next activity, place a car tire on the ground and then ask the children to see how many of them can stand in it at the same time. If a tire is not available, you could place a mat or towel, or some similar object, on the ground instead. Whatever object you choose, it should be small enough to make the game a challenge for the number of children in the class.

F. Coloring: Drawing 1

After the game, you can gather the children together and give them each a copy of Drawing 1 to color, explaining that the quotation they have memorized is at the bottom of the page and saying a few words you have prepared in advance about how the image relates to the theme of the lesson.

G. Closing prayers

To close the class, two or three children can be asked to recite a prayer they know or the quotation they have learned to say from memory. You can then offer a final prayer.

LESSON 2

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

It is suggested you open this and the next two classes with the prayer you recited at the start of Lesson 1. You can then ask a few of the children, selected in advance, to each say one they know. Afterwards, help your students continue memorizing the prayer introduced in the previous lesson.

B. Songs

For the next activity, the children can sing two songs—the one from the preceding lesson and this new one below regarding justice, which is the theme of the lesson.

A Noble Way

D
Justice is a noble way

A D
Justice brings a brighter day

G D
A light to those in need

A D
Shining through good deeds

D A D
Oh, justice is the way

D
We know ‘Abdu’l-Bahá would share

A D
Showing love and showing care

G D
He was content with less

A D
In order to bring happiness

D A D
He was content with less

(continued on next page)

D
To be just we have to give

A D
Share our love and joy to live

G D
Sharing blessings we receive

A D
A better world we will achieve

D A D
Oh, justice is the way

(repeat first stanza, singing last line twice)

C. Memorizing quotations

Following the two songs, you will encourage the children to memorize a quotation from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh. Here are some ideas for you to present the theme of the lesson and the quotation suggested:

> God loves justice. When there is justice, everyone enjoys the good things of life. Every child can go to school, every family has a comfortable home, and those who have more gladly give of the bounties they have received from God for the good of others. God is pleased with us when we treat one another with fairness and justice. If we see someone being mistreated, we should stand up for them and help them. We should not take from our friends or neighbors what is theirs. When something is to be shared, we have to make sure that no one is left out and that everybody receives a fair portion. To help us be just, let us memorize this quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:

"Tread ye the path of justice, for this, verily, is the straight path."[100]

It will be important to ensure that the children have a basic understanding of the above quotation before they begin to memorize it. A few sentences are provided below to help you explain the meaning of words that might be new to them.

Tread

1. Many leaves have fallen from the trees in the forest, covering the path. Fumiko walks through the forest. She treads the leaf-covered path.

2. Pedro likes to help all his friends play happily together. Pedro and his friends are very unified. Pedro treads the path of unity.

Path

1. Luis has a donkey. He took it to graze in a meadow and left it alone. The donkey found the path home by itself.

2. There are two ways to go to school. Millie always likes to take the path that goes by her grandmother's house.

Justice

1. Carlos was given crayons to hand out during class. There were ten crayons and five children. Carlos gave two crayons to each child. Carlos acted with justice in handing out the crayons.

2. Anna has lots of water in the well in her yard, but sometimes her neighbor's well runs dry. Anna never allows her neighbor to suffer and always makes her feel welcome to take water. Anna loves justice.

D. Story

After the children learn to recite the quotation from memory, you can tell them the story below about 'Abdu'l-Bahá that illustrates how just He was.

> *One day 'Abdu'l-Bahá wanted to go from 'Akká to Haifa. He went to take an inexpensive seat in a regular horse-drawn coach that was usually packed with people. The driver was surprised and must have asked himself why 'Abdu'l-Bahá was so frugal as to ride in this cheap coach. "Surely, Your Excellency would prefer to travel in a private carriage," he exclaimed. "No," replied the Master, and He traveled in the regular coach all the way to Haifa. As He stepped down from the coach in Haifa a distressed fisherwoman came to Him and asked for His help. All day she had caught nothing and now had to return to her hungry family. 'Abdu'l-Bahá gave her a good sum of money, turned to the driver and said, "Why should I ride in luxury while so many are starving?"*

E. Game: "The Burning Thirst"

Following the period dedicated to storytelling, the children will be eager to play a game. Tie sticks to their arms so that they are unable to bend their elbows, and then tell them to pretend they are walking together in a desert and are all very, very thirsty. When they come upon water in cups that you have set out for them, they must find a way to drink it. They will discover that the only way to do so is to help one another, while being careful not to get each other wet.

F. Coloring: Drawing 2

As the next activity, give each child a copy of Drawing 2 to color. You should remind the children that the quotation they have memorized is on the bottom of the page and should be prepared to say a few words about how the image relates to the theme of the lesson.

G. Closing prayers

When the children have finished coloring, you can invite a few of them to say a prayer or the quotation they memorized in this or the previous lesson. You can then offer a closing prayer.

LESSON 3

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

To open the class, recite a prayer from memory and ask a few children selected in advance to each say one as well. You can then spend some time with your students reviewing the prayer they began to learn in Lesson 1.

B. Songs

Start this next activity by having the children sing the two songs they learned in the previous lessons. Then teach them the song below, which is related to the theme of the lesson, love.

Love, Love, Love

C F
Love, love, love, love
G C
Love your fellow man
C F
Love, love, love is
D7 G
How the world began
C F
God loved creation
C G
So He created thee to
C F
Love, love, love Him
G C
And humanity

Love, love, love the
Everlasting good
Love, love, love the
Seed of brotherhood
Love all creation
For He created thee to
Love, love, love Him
And humanity

(continued on next page)

Love God's creatures
Be they near or far
See each human
As a shining star
Love all creation
For He created thee to
Love, love, love Him
And humanity

C. Memorizing quotations

To present the quotation for memorization, you can share with your students the following ideas related to the theme of the lesson:

> The love of God shines upon all of humanity like the rays of the sun. The sun's rays fall on dry deserts and green gardens alike. Through its warmth, seeds planted in fertile ground grow and bring forth precious fruit. So should we plant in the pure soil of our hearts the seeds of the love of God, which will grow and blossom under the warmth of His loving care. Then will our love spread forth, and we will show love to everyone, even to those who are sometimes unkind to us. To help us love all of humanity, let us memorize this quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:

"O Friend! In the garden of thy heart plant naught but the rose of love . . ."[101]

In this quotation the only word that may require explanation is "naught", which means "nothing".

1. Dineo loves to sing songs about the sun and the flowers, and he does not sing songs about anything else. Dineo sings of naught but sunshine and flowers.

2. Ta Jen wanted to go down to the river, but he had not done his household tasks. His father said he could not leave until he finished his work, and unfortunately Ta Jen became upset. His grandmother said, "My dear, all your plans will come to naught if you don't obey your father."

D. Story

After the period dedicated to memorization, you can tell your students the following story:

> *During the days that 'Abdu'l-Bahá lived in the prison-city of 'Akká, there was a man who behaved very badly towards Him. He thought that 'Abdu'l-Bahá was not a good man and that God did not care how badly the Bahá'ís were treated. In fact, he believed that he was showing love for God by showing hatred to the Bahá'ís. He hated 'Abdu'l-Bahá with all his heart. That hate grew and festered inside him, sometimes spilling out of him the way water spills out of a broken pot. In the mosque, when people came to pray, this man would cry out against 'Abdu'l-Bahá and say terrible things about Him. When he passed 'Abdu'l-Bahá on the street, he would cover his face with his robe so that he would not see Him.*

Now, this man was very poor and had neither enough to eat nor warm clothes to wear. What do you think 'Abdu'l-Bahá did? He showed him kindness, sent him food and clothes, and made sure he was being taken care of. For example, once when this man became very ill, 'Abdu'l-Bahá sent him a doctor, paid for his medicine and food, and also gave him some money. He accepted the gifts from 'Abdu'l-Bahá, but did not thank Him. Indeed, he held out one hand to the doctor to take his pulse, and with the other hand, covered his face so that he would not have to look upon the countenance of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. And so it went for many long years. And then, one day, the man's heart finally changed. He came to 'Abdu'l-Bahá's house, fell at His feet and with a very heavy heart and tears flowing down his face like twin rivers, cried, "Forgive me, Sir! For twenty-four years I have done evil to You. For twenty-four years You have shown only goodness to me. Now I know that I have been wrong. Please forgive me!" Thus did the great love of 'Abdu'l-Bahá triumph over hatred.

E. Game: "The Bridge"

For the next activity, you can use benches, boards, bricks, or tiles to make a line on the ground. This is the "bridge". Divide the children into two groups and tell them that both groups must cross the bridge at the same time, going in opposite directions, without letting anyone fall off the bridge. The children will discover that, to succeed, they have to help one another change places, passing each other one by one.

To assist them, you can gently guide the children to their starting places and help them go through the steps. Instead of putting all the youngsters on the bridge at once, you could practice with a few of them, two at a time. After several demonstrations, the number of children on the bridge can be increased, until everyone is participating.

F. Coloring: Drawing 3

Following the game, you can give each child a copy of Drawing 3 to color as a final activity. Remember to say a few words about how the image relates to the theme of the lesson.

G. Closing prayers

To end the class, encourage your students to sit quietly, while two or three of them recite a prayer or a quotation they have memorized. Then you or one of the children can offer a closing prayer.

LESSON 4

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After opening devotions, review with your students the prayer they have been learning by heart over the past few lessons.

B. Songs

For the next activity, have the children sing songs they learned in previous lessons, before teaching them this new one on the theme of truthfulness:

Truthful Words

G D
A mirror that's covered up in dust
A D
Cannot reflect the sun's bright light
G D
A bird with wings all full of mud
A D D7
Is unable to take flight

CHORUS:

G D
When all of our words are truthful
A D D7
Our souls are able to progress
G D
The foundation of all human virtues
A D
We know is truthfulness

CHORUS

A ship cannot catch the wind
If it is using a torn sail
Eyes can't see the path ahead
If they are covered up in veils

CHORUS *(with last line repeated)*

C. Memorizing quotations

It is suggested you present the theme of the lesson and the quotation for memorization in this way:

> Truthfulness is one of the most important spiritual qualities for every human being to have. We should never tell even the smallest lie, even if no one will find out. Sometimes people tell lies because they are afraid to tell the truth. Yet we know that

God is aware of all our actions and that we cannot hide anything from Him. We should love truth. If we are not truthful, it will be difficult for us to develop other qualities, like justice, love, and kindness, and for us to draw close to God. Let us memorize the following quotation of ‘Abdu’l-Bahá:

“Truthfulness is the foundation of all human virtues.”[102]

Below are some sentences to assist you in explaining the meaning of words in the above quotation that the children may find difficult.

Truthfulness

1. Sanjay dropped a glass and broke it. When his mother asked him what had happened, he told her the truth and did not lie. Sanjay acted with truthfulness.

2. Gita spent so much time playing one evening that she did not finish her homework. The next day, when the time came to hand it in, she decided she had to tell her teacher the truth, even though she realized he would be displeased. Gita acted with truthfulness.

Foundation

1. Alok’s father was building a house. Before putting up the walls, he placed rocks and cement under the place where the walls would go. The rocks and cement form the foundation of the house. It helps hold the house together.

2. Before you learn to read and write, you have to know the letters and their sounds. Learning the sounds of the letters is a foundation for learning to read and write.

Virtues

1. Aurora is friendly, courteous, and kind. Friendliness, politeness, and kindness are some of her many virtues.

2. Mrs. Patel teaches the children about justice, generosity, humility, and honesty. These are some of the important virtues everyone should possess.

D. Story

As the next activity, you can tell the following story to your students, which will help them think about the quality of truthfulness:

In a country far away, some time ago, there lived a young shepherd, who, while his father worked in the fields and his mother kept up the home, had the task of taking care of the family’s sheep. One day, the boy felt very bored and decided to play a trick on his neighbors. Suddenly he started crying out, “Wolf! Wolf! The wolf is eating the sheep!” All of his friends came running to help chase away the wolf, but when they got there they found the young shepherd laughing at them because they had received such a fright and really there was no wolf anywhere to be found. His friends went back to their work saying that the boy had behaved very badly.

The following day, the boy repeated his foolery. "Wolf! Wolf! Help me! Help me!" Some of the neighbors came running again to help, only to find the young shepherd laughing at them because this time, too, it was a lie that a wolf was near. The third day, when they heard the boy call "Wolf! Wolf! The wolf is eating the sheep! Please come help!" no one paid any attention; they thought that it was just another lie. That day the wolf did come and eat the sheep! The young shepherd was very sad, but he had learned a good lesson. If we tell lies, the day will come when neither our parents, our brothers and sisters, nor our friends will believe what we say, even when it is the truth!

E. Game: "Touch Telephone"

After telling the above story, you can have the children play a game. Ask them to stand in a line. They should all face in the same direction, with the last child looking at a piece of paper hanging on a wall or tree or, if available, at a blackboard. He or she will need some kind of instrument for writing. More than one line can be organized, if there are many children.

Now, using your finger, draw something on the back of the first child, who will, in turn, draw it on the back of the second child. The second child should then draw it on the third child's back, and so on, until the drawing reaches the last child, who should draw it on the piece of paper or blackboard. Now you should draw next to it what you had traced with your finger on the first child's back. Your drawings should be simple so that all the children can replicate them.

F. Coloring: Drawing 4

You can hand out in the usual way copies of Drawing 4 for the children to color as the next activity.

G. Closing prayers

As always, close the class by asking the children to sit quietly while quotations and prayers are recited.

LESSON 5

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

For this and the next three lessons, you should begin the class by reciting another prayer you know from memory, and one is suggested in Section 6 for this purpose. After a few of the children have joined you in reciting opening prayers, you can introduce the one below for them to memorize. It is expected that they will all be able to learn at least part of the prayer in this class and will be able to recite it from memory in its entirety by Lesson 8.

"O God, guide me, protect me, make of me a shining lamp and a brilliant star. Thou art the Mighty and the Powerful."[103]

B. Songs

For this lesson, in addition to teaching the children the song below, you can sing with them a few others they already know.

Fountain of Generosity

C
Be a fountain, be a spring
C G
Be an ever-flowing thing
F C
It is true that if you do
Dm7 G7 C
Happiness will come to you
F C
Search your heart every day
D7 G7
Is there something you can give away

Happiness should be your goal
Give your heart, and give your soul
It is true that if you do
God will always be with you
Search your heart every day
Is there something you can give away

Happiness should be your goal
Give your heart, and give your soul
It is true that if you do
God will always be with you

C. Memorizing quotations

The following ideas will help you introduce the theme of the lesson and the quotation the children will memorize:

> God is very generous with His creation. He showers the plants with rain and provides food and nourishment for the animals and for human beings. He looks after all of us. He has given us many gifts: eyes with which to see the mountains, the rivers, the stars, and all the beauty around us; ears with which to listen to melodious songs, the chirping of birds, the advice of our parents, and the Word of God. He has given us intelligence with which we can learn about the mysteries of the universe and, above all, He has given us spiritual powers with which we can know and love Him. Just as God is generous with us, we should be generous with others. We should give of what

we have—of our food, of our possessions, of our time, of our knowledge—to meet the needs of others. We should share our love, our joy, and the good things we learn at home and in school. To assist us in our efforts to be generous, let us memorize this quotation of Bahá'u'lláh that reminds us of God's generosity:

"To give and to be generous are attributes of Mine; well is it with him that adorneth himself with My virtues."[104]

Generous

1. Ram and Rajish have saved a little money. They decide to buy some books for their younger brothers and sisters. Ram and Rajish are generous.

2. Mrs. Murphy spent the whole morning baking cakes. Before taking them to town to sell, she gave two large cakes to the neighbors. Mrs. Murphy is generous.

Attribute

1. The stone is very hard. Hardness is an attribute of stones.

2. "One of your attributes is that you are hard working," the teacher said to Charlene.

Adorn

1. Tonight there is a devotional gathering at the community center. The children picked flowers to place in the meeting room. The room is adorned with flowers.

2. Li Feng has a bright smile. A smile adorns his face most of the time.

D. Story

In this lesson, you will tell the children the following story, which will assist them in reflecting on the concept of generosity:

One day, 'Abdu'l-Bahá was invited by the man in charge of the sheep owned by His Father, Bahá'u'lláh, to spend the day in the countryside with the shepherds. 'Abdu'l-Bahá was a small child at the time, and it was long before Bahá'u'lláh and His family were forced to leave their beloved homeland. Bahá'u'lláh had a good deal of land in the mountains and large flocks of sheep. With His mother's consent, 'Abdu'l-Bahá joined the shepherds and had a wonderful day in their company as they sang, danced and prepared a beautiful feast. When the day came to an end and 'Abdu'l-Bahá was ready to leave, the shepherds all gathered around Him and gave farewell speeches. The man who had accompanied 'Abdu'l-Bahá explained that it was customary for those who owned land and flocks of sheep to offer parting gifts. 'Abdu'l-Bahá became silent for a while. He did not have anything to give them, but the man had insisted that the shepherds were expecting something. Then 'Abdu'l-Bahá had an idea: He would give the shepherds a few sheep from the very flock they were tending. Bahá'u'lláh was greatly pleased when He heard about 'Abdu'l-Bahá's generous thoughts towards the shepherds. He humorously remarked that everyone had better take good care of 'Abdu'l-Bahá because someday He would give Himself

away. Of course, this is exactly what 'Abdu'l-Bahá did for the rest of His life. He gave everything He had, each and every moment of His life, to humanity, to unite us and bring us true happiness.

E. Game: "The Twins"

After the period of storytelling, the children will, as always, play a game. Divide them into pairs, trying as much as possible to have children of the same height work together. Ask each pair to stand back to back and squat down. Then tell them to hook elbows and try to stand up. Once they have succeeded, have groups of three or four children try to do the same.

F. Coloring: Drawing 5

As a final activity, you can hand out copies of Drawing 5 for the children to color.

G. Closing prayers

The class can close in the usual way, with prayers and quotations recited by you and a few children.

LESSON 6

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After you and a few students have said opening devotions, you can help the children continue learning the prayer introduced in Lesson 5.

B. Songs

As the next activity, teach the children to sing the following song, which is related to the theme of the lesson. They can also sing a few others they especially enjoy.

Prefer Your Brother

C G/B Am7 C
I am thirsty, I am thirsty

Dm G C Am7
But my brother, he comes first

F Em Dm C
So I offer him the water

Dm G C
That will quench his thirst

(continued on next page)

CHORUS:

F G C Am
It is a blessing to prefer your brother

F G C Am
This is a way to show you care

F G C Am
It is a blessing to prefer your sister

F G C
You are richer, the more you share

I am hungry, I am hungry
And my sister, she is too
So I give her some of my food
That's what's best to do

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

In this lesson, the children will learn to recite a quotation from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh that calls us to selflessness. You could present this theme in the following way:

> God loves each and every one of us, and He has created the human heart to know Him and to love Him. When our hearts are pure, we are able to see the signs of God reflected in His creation. We see His generosity, His kindness, His mercy. In our love for God, we want to bring joy and happiness to all those we see around us—to our parents, to our brothers and sisters, to our friends and neighbors. Our love is so great that what gladdens us most is to bring joy to others and to put their comfort before our own. So it is that we think of our fellow human beings before we think of ourselves. Let us memorize the following quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:

"Blessed is he who preferreth his brother before himself."[105]

Blessed

1. Amelia's mother asked her to go to the store and buy five items. She did not make a list but remembered to buy them all, not forgetting a single one. Amelia is blessed with a good memory.

2. Victor's family says prayers together every morning in their home. The home of Victor's family is blessed by the remembrance of God.

Prefers

1. Anoushka's grandmother likes both mint tea and lemon tea, but when she has a choice, she chooses mint tea. She prefers mint tea.

2. Veasna can go out and play or go help her father in the garden. She decides to help her father in the garden. Veasna prefers to help her father.

D. Story

The story below illustrates how, through both His words and His deeds, ‘Abdu’l-Bahá shows us the ways of selflessness.

> *‘Abdu’l-Bahá preferred inexpensive clothes for Himself. More important to Him was to be scrupulously clean. When He had extra clothes, He always gave them away to others. One day He was going to entertain the governor of ‘Akká. His wife felt that His coat was not good enough for the special occasion. Well ahead of time she went to the tailor and ordered a fine coat for ‘Abdu’l-Bahá. When the day of the governor’s visit arrived, the new coat was laid out for Him. But ‘Abdu’l-Bahá went searching for His old one. How could such an expensive coat, like the one laid out, possibly be His? For the same amount, five ordinary coats could be made. “Then, you see,” He told His wife, “I shall not only have a new one, but I shall also have four to give to others!”*

E. Game: “The Snail”

For the next activity, tell the children they are going to be a snail. To succeed, they must stand in a line, hold hands, and not let go. The person on one end will be the center, and he or she must stand very still. The child at the other end must guide everyone else in the line to wind around the child in the center. Little by little they should wind themselves into a spiral to form a snail.

As an alternative to the above game, tell the children to stand in a line again and hold hands. Then ask the child at one end to begin to turn in a circle, slowly winding the others up around him or her. Make sure they are careful not to step on one another’s feet when doing so.

If time allows, once the children have formed a snail, tell those in the middle to bend down and the one at the center to go under the arms of a child next to him or her, continuing through the arms of others until he or she has emerged out of the snail. The other children, while continuing to hold hands, should follow him or her through one another’s arms until they all have emerged and formed a line once again. Clearly, for this game to work, you must have a sufficient number of children in the class.

F. Coloring: Drawing 6

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 7

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

You can review with the children the prayer they began to memorize in Lesson 5, after you and a few of the youngsters have said opening devotions.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Joy Gives Us Wings

D A D G D
Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings
D A D A D
Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings

A D
In times of joy, our strength grows in might
A D
In times of joy, our intellect takes flight
A D
In times of joy, our understanding is bright
D A D A D
Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings

Dm A7 Dm A7 Dm
But when sadness visits us, when sadness visits us
A Dm A Dm
We become weak, our strength goes away
A Dm A Dm
Our insights are dim, our thoughts become gray
A7
How-ev-er

Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings
Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings

In times of joy, our strength grows in might
In times of joy, our intellect takes flight
In times of joy, our understanding is bright
Joy gives us wings to fly, joy gives us wings

C. Memorizing quotations

The following will assist you in presenting the quotation that the children will memorize in this lesson, which is focused on the theme of joyfulness:

> ‘Abdu’l-Bahá tells us that joy gives us wings, that when joyful we are stronger, and that when happy we are quicker to understand. Joyfulness is a quality of the human heart. With hearts full of joy, we see the blessings of God everywhere around us—the blessing of loving parents, the blessing of friendship, and, above all, the blessing

to know Him and to love Him. We must be happy and joyful under all conditions and do our best to bring joy to others. ‘Abdu’l-Bahá wants all children to shine like brilliant lamps shedding the light of joy everywhere. To help us remember that we should always be joyful, let us memorize the following quotation:

“O Son of Man! Rejoice in the gladness of thine heart, that thou mayest be worthy to meet Me and to mirror forth My beauty.”[106]

Rejoice

1. Ronald lives far from his grandparents. When he heard that he would be visiting them during the school holidays, he became very happy. His heart rejoiced.

2. Mouzhgan helped her mother and her father to plant cucumber seeds in their garden. Her heart rejoiced when the first small cucumbers began to appear.

Worthy

1. Sjona studied very hard and received excellent grades. The teacher praised her diligence and hard work. Sjona’s hard work was worthy of the teacher’s praise.

2. David always took good care of his brothers and sisters. His parents knew they could trust him with the children. David was worthy of his parents’ trust.

Mirror forth

1. Amari polished the stone he found until it became so shiny it began to mirror forth light.

2. Hearts that are pure mirror forth the attributes of God.

Beauty

1. Ilana’s mother enjoys seeing birds flying in the sky, flowers in bloom, and the ocean’s waves rolling onto the shore. She sees beauty in nature.

2. Sometimes the beauty of a song touches our hearts so much that it brings tears to our eyes.

3. Whenever Munir says prayers, he remembers God’s beauty, His love, His generosity, and His wisdom.

D. Story

The story below will illustrate for the children how ‘Abdu’l-Bahá brought joy to the hearts of those around Him.

Leroy Ioas was an outstanding Bahá’í that you will probably learn more about as you grow. He was a young boy in 1912 when the Master visited the city of Chicago. Can you imagine the excitement of this spiritual child at having the opportunity to be in the presence of ‘Abdu’l-Bahá? One day, as he and his father were on their way to the

hotel where the Master was staying, Leroy had an idea: he decided that he wanted to take 'Abdu'l-Bahá some flowers. With the little money he had, he managed to buy a beautiful bouquet of white carnations. But by the time they reached the hotel, he had changed his mind. He decided that he did not want to give anything material to the Master, not even beautiful flowers. He would offer Him his heart. That was the most important thing he had to offer. So, Leroy's father presented the flowers to 'Abdu'l-Bahá without mentioning who had brought them.

'Abdu'l-Bahá then gave a talk to all the friends who had gathered at the hotel to meet Him. During His talk, Leroy sat quietly at His feet and listened to His wise and loving words. Afterwards, the Master stood up and shook hands with the guests, giving each one a white carnation as a token of His love. Leroy was now standing behind the Master. "Oh! I wish He would turn around and give me one of those flowers," thought the young boy. Maybe, secretly in his heart, he wanted the Master to know who had really brought Him the beautiful flowers. But, one by one, the white carnations were being given to other people, and it seemed unlikely that Leroy was going to get one. Then, suddenly, the Master turned around and fixed His gaze on Leroy Ioas. His face radiated love and His eyes were full of kindness. And did He hand him a white carnation? No. 'Abdu'l-Bahá gave Leroy something even more precious. He was wearing a beautiful red rose on His coat. He pulled it off and presented it to the young boy. Leroy's heart leaped with joy. The Master did know who had brought Him the white carnations after all.

E. Game: "Catching the Dragon's Tail"

To begin the next activity, ask the children to stand in a line, placing their hands on the shoulders or the waist of the one in front of them. The first child in the line will be the dragon's head. The last in line will be the dragon's tail, eager to lash to the right and left in order to escape the head. Until the signal "Go" is given, the dragon must be a straight line. One youngster should count, "One, two, three, go!" On the signal "Go", the head should run around toward the tail and try to catch it. The whole body must move with the head and remain unbroken. If the head succeeds in touching the tail, or if the body breaks before he or she does so, the head becomes the tail, and the next in line becomes the head. The game can continue in this way until every child has had a chance to be the head and the tail at least once.

F. Coloring: Drawing 7

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 8

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

Open the class in the usual way by saying a prayer from memory and asking a few students selected in advance to do so as well. You can then review with the children the prayer they began learning in Lesson 5.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

At All Times

CHORUS:

E A
We should at all times manifest
B E A B
Our truthfulness and sincerity

E A
We should at all times manifest
B E A B
Our truthfulness and sincerity *(repeat)*

E A B
When I speak, I share from the bottom of my heart
E A B
I let kind and true words be my art
E A B
Oh what a treasure is sincerity
A E B E
A beautiful mix of honesty and purity
A E B E A E
Oh what a treasure is sincerity

When I serve, I give from the bottom of my heart
I purify my thoughts and pray before I start
This way my actions can build true unity
Oh what a treasure is sincerity
Oh what a treasure is sincerity

When I pray, I pray from the bottom of my heart
I close my eyes and think of God
I don't think of my desire, I don't think of what I need
I think of how sincerity can shine through my deeds
Oh what a treasure is sincerity

CHORUS *(repeat twice)*

C. Memorizing quotations

To present the quotation for memorization, you can draw on the following ideas related to the theme of the lesson:

> When our words and deeds reflect what is in our hearts, we show forth the quality of sincerity. Sincerity inspires us to be truthful and faithful in our dealings with others. For example, when we say that we are sorry for something we have done and we also know in our hearts that we will make every effort not to repeat our wrongdoings, we are being sincere. It is through our sincerity that others can see the purity of our hearts and place their trust in us. To help us remember the importance of this quality, we will memorize the following quotation of ‘Abdu’l-Bahá:

“We should at all times manifest our truthfulness and sincerity . . .”[107]

Manifest

1. Csaba cleaned the mud off the seashell that he found at the beach and polished it until it was smooth and shiny. When he was finished, the shell’s true beauty became manifest.

2. As the sun rose and the morning fog lifted, the splendor of the mountains became manifest.

Sincerity

1. Leo’s classmates often play games instead of studying. Leo is worried that they will not do well in school, so he suggests that they all study together and tries to think of ways that they can help each other learn. Leo’s concern for his classmates is sincere.

2. Rosa promised her mother that she would do her homework every day. When her parents are away, Rosa diligently works on her homework assignments. Rosa was sincere in her promise.

D. Story

The story you narrate to the children in this lesson will help them think about what it means to possess the quality of sincerity and to see when it is lacking.

> *For many years a large tree stood behind a house that belonged to a husband and wife with several children. As the tree grew, its branches reached up and out, shading the back of the family’s home. One winter morning, the father was passing under the tree when he met a neighbor. They spoke briefly of the comings and goings in the village. After a while, the neighbor, taking notice of the large tree, said to the man, “You know, it really is time for you to cut that enormous tree down. It is sprawling and unruly. What if one of the branches were to break off and fall onto your roof—or worse yet, hit one of your children while they were playing in the shade?” When the two had parted, the man considered his neighbor’s advice. The tree had stood in this place since before he could remember, and no harm had come of it. It gave good shade in the summer and shielded the house from the bitter winds of winter. It seemed sturdy and strong. “Still, perhaps my neighbor has a point,” the man said to*

himself. "Appearances can sometimes be deceiving. What if the tree is not as sturdy as it seems?" And so he decided to cut it down.

It was a difficult job, for the tree was very big, indeed, and had many limbs and branches, some of them quite high. Just as the man finished, his neighbor returned, this time accompanied by his two sons and a cart. "I see you decided to take down the tree," the neighbor said, looking at the many stacks of wood. "I suppose you'll need someone to take those piles away. Perhaps we can help you. I have brought my cart and my two sons, and we will be happy to remove all this from your yard." Without waiting for an answer, the sons began loading the wood into the waiting cart. As they walked away with the loaded cart, the man sat down on the stump of the tree that had sheltered his home for so long. It was then that he realized that his neighbor had not been concerned for his family's safety after all, but for the supply of firewood that would keep him warm through the winter months. "Appearances can, indeed, sometimes be deceiving," he said with a sigh. How sad that the family lost its beautiful tree that day. But sadder still—the neighbor lost the trust of his friend and an opportunity to win the good pleasure of God.

E. Game: "Hot or Cold"

Begin by blindfolding one of the children and asking him or her to turn away from the group. Have the others hide a small object, for example, a pencil or crayon, and then remove the blindfold from the first child, who will now look for the hidden object. The others should help by clapping louder and louder the closer the child gets to the hiding place. If the child moves away from the place where the object is hidden, the clapping will become softer and softer. Instead of clapping, the children can call out "warm", "warmer", and "hot" as the child who is looking gets nearer to the object and "cold", "colder", and "freezing" if the child moves away from it. The children should be careful not to mislead the friend who is searching for the hidden object; otherwise he or she will lose trust in the others, and the game will become futile.

F. Coloring: Drawing 8

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 9

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

To begin this and the next three classes, choose a prayer to recite by heart, such as the one suggested in Section 10. A few students can join you in saying opening prayers, after which you can introduce the one below for memorization. This prayer is longer than the previous two memorized by the children, but it will not be difficult for them to grasp, and they should all be able to commit it to memory by Lesson 12.

"Blessed is the spot, and the house, and the place, and the city, and the heart, and the mountain, and the refuge, and the cave, and the valley, and the land, and the sea, and the island, and the meadow where mention of God hath been made, and His praise glorified."[108]

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Be Like the Earth

C G
See the earth

F G C
It's so humble

C G
Has all God's wealth to give

F G C
Everything we need to live

C G
Lets us walk on it every day

F G C
But have you ever heard it say

C G
"I am richer

F G C
Greater than you"

See the tree
It's so humble
The more its fruits abound
It bows closer to the ground
And shares the fruit that way
But have you ever heard it say
"I am richer
Greater than you"

C G
Be like the earth

F G C
Be like the tree

C G
Rise to the heaven of glory

F G C
On the wings of humility

C G
Rise to the heaven of glory

F G C
On the wings of humility

C. Memorizing quotations

The ideas below will help you to introduce the theme of this lesson and the quotation for memorization.

A very important spiritual quality is humility. Those who are humble before God recognize the greatness of God and His creation. They know that, without His assistance and grace, none of us can achieve anything. He is the Almighty, the All-Powerful. And, just as we would never show pride before God, we remain humble before all of His creation. We remember that the earth and everyone on it were created by Him and reflect His signs and attributes. We respect nature and know in our hearts that there is always something we can learn from those around us. Let us memorize the following quotation:

"O Son of Man! Humble thyself before Me, that I may graciously visit thee."[109]

Humble

1. Zainab works diligently on her math assignments and always does well. She is humble and never boasts about her achievements.

2. The children in Yong Fu's neighborhood are eager to learn, and he was asked to form a small class for them. Even though he has little experience and considers himself unworthy, he puts his trust in God and does his best. He approaches the task with humility.

Graciously

1. Candace's family has invited a few neighbors to their home for a meal. When the guests arrive, Candace greets them warmly and graciously offers them a cool drink.

2. Giovanni saw his elderly neighbor struggling to walk home with her grocery bags, so he graciously offered to carry them for her.

D. Story

Humility was one of 'Abdu'l-Bahá's most notable qualities. Many people wanted to give Him great titles, but He only wanted to be called "'Abdu'l-Bahá", which means "Servant of the Glory". His most ardent desire was to serve. One time, some wealthy visitors made an elaborate plan for Him to wash His hands before a meal. They arranged for a specially dressed boy to carry a fancy bowl with "crystal water", and they also had a perfumed towel waiting for Him. When the Master saw the group of friends approaching from across the lawn—with the little boy, the bowl, and the towel—He knew their purpose. He hurriedly found some water nearby, washed His hands, and dried them with a piece of cloth the gardener had. Radiantly, He turned to greet the group. And then, bestowing on His guests the very honor that was meant for Him, He lovingly offered them the water and perfumed towel!

E. Game: "Sometimes We Are Tall"

Blindfold one child and have the rest form a circle around him or her. In unison, have them say:

"We are very tall." (They should stand on their toes and stretch as tall as they can.)

"We are very short." (They should squat down and make themselves as short as they can.)

"Sometimes we are tall." (They stretch up again.)

"Sometimes we are short." (They squat down again.)

Now gesture to the children, indicating whether they should stand tall or squat down, and have them say together:

"Guess what we are now!"

The blindfolded child should try to guess by the level of their voices whether they are "short" or "tall". Each child should take a turn at being blindfolded.

F. Coloring: Drawing 9

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 10

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After opening devotions, the children can continue memorizing the prayer introduced in the last lesson.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

I Thank and Praise Thee Lord

C Am Em
I thank and praise Thee Lord
F G
For the crown of mercy
C Am
Set upon my head

(continued on next page)

F C
It will forever glow

G7 Am
The more gratitude I show

Dm G7 C
I thank and praise Thee Lord

I thank and praise Thee Lord
For the love and knowledge
Implanted in my heart
They will grow and grow
The more gratitude I show
I thank and praise Thee Lord

I thank and praise Thee Lord
For the light of truth
That illumines my eyes
I will see Thy bounties flow
The more gratitude I show
I thank and praise Thee Lord
I thank and praise Thee Lord

C. Memorizing quotations

The quotation for memorization can be introduced to your students in the following way:

> When we receive even the smallest of gifts, we thank the person who gave it to us. How much more, then, should we be thankful to God for His innumerable gifts and bounties—caring eyes to watch over us, hearts to love us, and all that He has created so we can grow and develop. ‘Abdu’l-Bahá tells us that we should be thankful to God for the many bounties He has given us and for filling our hearts with His love. We must be thankful to God at all times, even in times of difficulty. Giving thanks to God enables us to receive more and more of His infinite bounties. Let us memorize the following quotation:
>
> **“Be thou happy. Be thou grateful. Arise to render thanks unto God, that thy thankfulness may conduce to an increase of bounty.”[110]**

Arise

1. Salma was glad to see her grandmother arise from bed and go for a walk after a long illness.

2. The children arise early every morning to say prayers.

Conduce

1. Nadia is always clean. She knows that cleanliness is important for spiritual growth. Cleanliness conduces to spirituality.

2. The members of Seff's family cooperate and help one another in all important matters. Because they cooperate, they live in harmony. Cooperation conduces to harmony.

Increase

1. Last year, Maria's school had only five teachers. This year it has eight teachers. The number of teachers at the school has increased by three.

2. Shayan is a joyful boy, and his joy grows even more whenever he is able to help others. His joy increases when he serves others.

D. Story

One day, a wealthy lady came from very far away to see 'Abdu'l-Bahá in the Holy Land. At great length, she began to tell Him of her small troubles, one after the other. 'Abdu'l-Bahá listened with patience and kindness for quite some time until, eventually, another appointment called Him away. Before leaving His guest, however, He pointed to a gentleman walking outside the window. "There goes a man whom I will bring in to see you," He said. "His name is Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí. He walks on earth but he lives in heaven," 'Abdu'l-Bahá explained. "He has had many troubles and he will tell you about them."

Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí had had many troubles indeed. He was from Persia, where Bahá'ís were treated with injustice and great cruelty. Some were arrested and wrongly imprisoned; others were beaten by people full of hatred and anger. It would sadden your hearts too much to hear about all the sufferings that Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí endured in his life.

Now, 'Abdu'l-Bahá went out to fetch Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí and bring him in to meet His guest. After introducing him to the lady, 'Abdu'l-Bahá departed. Immediately Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí began to speak to her with great joy and humility of the wonderful time in which we live and of all the blessings of God to come. The guest listened for a little while, then, impatient, interrupted saying, "But 'Abdu'l-Bahá said you would tell me about your troubles." Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí looked up in amazement. "Troubles?" he replied. "Why madam, I never had any troubles. I don't know what troubles are." Of course, 'Abdu'l-Bahá knew that, even though Mírzá Ḥaydar-'Alí had experienced great hardships, they never touched his happiness, and he saw only all the blessings God had given him in life, for which he was thankful.

E. Game: "Quick Impulse"

Ask the students to form a circle holding hands. First, have them practice squeezing their left hands and then their right hands. Afterwards, explain to them that they are going to send a "pulse" signal through the group. One child will begin by quickly squeezing the hand of the child to his or her right, who will pass the signal on to the next child, and so on, until it returns to the first child. The children should be timed and challenged to go faster

and faster. Once they have learned this basic game, you can ask them to send the pulse in the opposite direction or to increase the number of squeezes per pulse.

F. Coloring: Drawing 10

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 11

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

Open the class in the usual way by reciting a prayer from memory and inviting a few of the students to say one. You can then help the children continue memorizing the prayer they began to learn in Lesson 9.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Looking for Good

C
I've got excellence as my goal
F7
But I've got a long, long way to go
C
And I know it helps me on my way
G7 C
When I see the good in every day
F7
So if I see something you do wrong
C
I won't sing about it in this song
G7
I won't talk about it with my friends
F7 C
I won't even think about it again

CHORUS:

F7
I'll look at the good in you
C
I'll look at the good in you

(continued on next page)

G7
I know that you'd want me to

F7 C
'Cause that's what I'd want you to do

F7
And God looks for the good in me

C Am
He looks for the good in me

C G
And when I put a cover

F7
On those little faults of others

C G7 C
I hope God will put a cover on my faults too

'Abdu'l-Bahá was very wise
He saw your heart inside your eyes
And when He noticed something wrong
He'd find some way to make you strong
So if I find some fault in you
I know just what I have to do
I won't go tell anybody else
No, I won't even tell myself

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

It is suggested you introduce the theme of the lesson and the quotation for memorization by sharing with your students the following ideas:

> Forgiveness is one of the attributes of God. 'Abdu'l-Bahá tells us we should always be forgiving with one another. We should see with the eyes of forgiveness and not look at one another's faults. If we follow 'Abdu'l-Bahá's example, we will show forgiveness not only to our friends when they make mistakes but also to those who are unkind to us. To help us in our efforts to be forgiving, let us memorize the following quotation:

> **". . . let your adorning be forgiveness and mercy and that which cheereth the hearts of the well-favored of God."[111]**

Mercy

1. The rain went on for days and days. Even when the village flooded, the rain did not stop. The rain showed no mercy.

2. When we pray to God, He forgives our mistakes. He shows us mercy.

Cheer

1. Ursula was not feeling well. Her friend Elsie brought her flowers and sat with her for a long time, telling stories and talking. Elsie's visit made Ursula feel much better. Her visit cheered Ursula's heart.

2. Mrs. Sanchez received a long letter from her husband who had gone away to a nearby town for work. The letter brought the good news that he would soon be coming home. The news greatly cheered her.

Favored

1. The teacher loved all of her students and paid special attention to each one. She favored them all.

2. James liked all of the subjects at school, but he did best in science. Science was the subject he favored most.

D. Story

During the days the Master lived in 'Akká, there was a governor who, time and time again, tried to harm the Bahá'ís. On one occasion he came up with a plan to destroy their means of livelihood: he ordered his guards to close down the shops of all the Bahá'ís and to bring him the keys. But 'Abdu'l-Bahá learned of the governor's plan and advised the friends not to open their shops the next day. He told them to wait and see what God would ordain.

Imagine the governor's surprise when he heard that his guards could not bring him the keys because the shops had not been opened. But before he could think of what to do next, something unexpected happened. A telegram arrived from his superiors dismissing him from his post as governor of the city. And so the shops of the Bahá'ís were saved.

The ex-governor was ordered to leave 'Akká and go to another city called Damascus. He did not know what to do. He had to leave quickly and alone. What would happen to his family? Who would help someone who had lost the favor of the government? The Master heard the news and went to see him. He showered the unhappy man with great kindness, as if he had never been an enemy of the Faith. Not once did He mention his past wrongdoings. Instead, He offered to help him in whatever way possible. The ex-governor was worried about leaving his wife and children behind. 'Abdu'l-Bahá assured him that He would take care of the matter. Later He arranged for a comfortable trip, provided someone reliable to accompany the wife and children, paid for all the expenses, and sent the family on its way to Damascus.

When the ex-governor was reunited with his family, he rejoiced. With a heart filled with gratitude, he turned to the man who had traveled with his family and asked him about the cost of the journey. The man explained that it had been paid by 'Abdu'l-Bahá. Then the ex-governor offered him a present for his kindness and diligence during the journey. But he would not accept the present; he said that he was merely obeying 'Abdu'l-Bahá and did not wish to receive anything for his services. The ex-governor then asked the man to stay the night as a guest in his home. He said, however, that

he was eager to follow the instructions of the Master, Who had told him to return to 'Akká without delay. The ex-governor asked the man to wait at least long enough for him to write a letter to 'Abdu'l-Bahá. This he accepted and upon his return to 'Akká delivered the letter to the Master. The letter read: "O 'Abdu'l-Bahá, I pray you pardon me. I did not understand. I did not know you. I have wrought you great evil. You have rewarded me with great good."

E. Game: "People to People"

Tell the children to walk around randomly while clapping and saying, "people to people". When you call out "back to back", they should stop, and each back up to a partner. On your signal, they should start to move around again, clapping and saying, "people to people". When you call out "face to face", they should stop and each face a partner, bowing heads. The game can continue in this way, with these two commands being repeated several times. Other commands can then be included, for example, "knee to knee" and "elbow to elbow".

F. Coloring: Drawing 11

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 12

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

As always, the class should begin with opening prayers. You can then review with the children the prayer they have been learning over the last three lessons. You should make sure they can all say it well, since you will be introducing a new prayer for them to memorize in Lesson 13.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Brighter Than the Sun

C G D G
Truthfulness is brighter than the light of the sun

C G D G
Truthfulness is brighter than the light of the sun

C G D G
With truthfulness, O people, beautify your tongues

C G D G
With truthfulness, O people, beautify your tongues

Honesty adorns the soul of everyone
Honesty adorns the soul of everyone
Honesty is brighter than the light of the sun
Honesty is brighter than the light of the sun

C. Memorizing quotations

Below are a few ideas that you can share with your students to present the theme of the lesson, which is honesty, and the quotation they will memorize.

> Gardens are adorned with flowers of different shapes and colors. In the spring, fruit trees are adorned with fragrant blossoms. We adorn ourselves with clean and spotless garments. All of these adornments create beauty. Yet, more than material things, it is the radiance of spiritual qualities that make human beings beautiful, that bring joy to our hearts. One of the most beautiful qualities that can adorn our lives is honesty. When we beautify ourselves with honesty, we do not take things that belong to others without their permission, we never cheat or trick anyone into doing something. To help us remember the quality of honesty, let us memorize the following quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:
>
> **"Beautify your tongues, O people, with truthfulness, and adorn your souls with the ornament of honesty."[112]**

Beautify

1. Malit planted beautiful roses in the garden. The roses beautify the garden.

2. Sunil only tells the truth. His words are always beautified with truthfulness.

D. Story

> *During the later part of His life, 'Abdu'l-Bahá was able to travel to many places around the world. Wherever He went, He would meet with people from all walks of life—laborers and leaders, educators and scientists—and He did whatever He could to make everyone feel at ease. One day, in Egypt, He had invited a high-ranking government official to be His guest for lunch. 'Abdu'l-Bahá decided to hire a carriage to drive them to their destination, as the official was accustomed to this sort of comfort.*
>
> *The ride was not long, and they soon arrived at their luncheon. But when the carriage driver approached 'Abdu'l-Bahá for payment, he asked much more than a fair price for the trip. 'Abdu'l-Bahá knew that the driver was not being honest. He paid the man only what he was owed, then turned to leave.*
>
> *When the driver tried to argue, 'Abdu'l-Bahá stood firm. He told the man that, if he had been honest about the fare, he would have been rewarded with a handsome tip. Then the Master walked away, leaving the driver to think about his actions.*

E. Game: "Square, Circle, Triangle"

It is assumed that the children know the names of at least a few shapes, such as "square", "circle", and "triangle". Begin by reviewing the names of these shapes with the children, making sure that they can identify each one. Next, hold up a card on which you have drawn a sequence of three shapes—for instance, circle, circle, square—and tell them to look at it closely. Then put the card away and ask one of the children to say the sequence out loud. Repeat this several times, using cards on which you have drawn a variety of sequences beforehand. You should have some cards with only two shapes, in case a sequence of three

is too difficult for the children to remember, and a few cards with a sequence of four or five, in case they find a sequence of three too easy.

Now try calling out a sequence of shapes—either two, three, or four shapes, depending on your students' ability—and ask one child in the group to repeat it. After you have done this several times with each child, you can make the game more challenging by having the children draw the sequence that you call out.

F. Coloring: Drawing 12

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 13

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

In this and the next three classes, the children will focus their efforts on learning to recite the prayer below by heart. You can introduce it to them after you have offered an opening prayer from memory, such as the one suggested in Section 13, and after a few of your students have also done so.

> **"O Lord! Plant this tender seedling in the garden of Thy manifold bounties, water it from the fountains of Thy loving-kindness and grant that it may grow into a goodly plant through the outpourings of Thy favor and grace.**
>
> **"Thou art the Mighty and the Powerful."[113]**

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Be Fair

CHORUS:

A
Be fair, be fair
E7 A
And strive to provide for the comfort of all
A
Be fair, be fair
E7 A
And strive to provide for the comfort of all

(continued on next page)

A E
When we are fair in our dealings with others

E7 A
We gain the trust of our sisters and brothers

A7 D
When things are divided equitably

E A
Justice will shine for the world to see

CHORUS

When you give true comfort and aid
You'll follow the path that the Master laid
When wise and just in what you say and do
You'll bring joy to hearts around you

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

In this lesson, the children will learn a quotation related to the quality of compassion, which you can present as follows:

> God is the Most Compassionate, the All-Merciful. In times of difficulty, we turn our hearts to Him and ask Him to comfort and strengthen us. So, too, must we show compassion to others. When someone we know has a problem or is sad, we should do our best to be understanding and to help him or her. We must be compassionate and kind with everyone, under all conditions, like the tree that gives fruit to one and all, even to those who throw stones at it. 'Abdu'l-Bahá showed forth compassion at all times, to all people, though His life was filled with hardship. To help us in our efforts to be compassionate, let us memorize His words:
>
> **"The Kingdom of God is founded upon equity and justice, and also upon mercy, compassion, and kindness to every living soul."[114]**

Founded

1. The doctor was concerned about the health of children in the villages, and so he opened a clinic to care for them. The clinic was founded out of his love for children.

2. Jenna and Mercedes have been friends for a very long time. They always study together and share with each other useful things they have learned. Their friendship is founded on kindness and love.

Equity

1. All of the people in the kingdom worked hard for its prosperity. When all of the crops were gathered, the king divided them among his subjects, according to the size of their families. The king treated his subjects with equity.

2. The town council had to build a road to the next village. It decided to wind the road around the farmland. In this way many were able to benefit from the new road but the farmers did not suffer. The council showed a sense of equity in its decision.

Compassion

1. Li Yong noticed that his friend Zahra was unhappy, so he went to find out whether he could help her in any way. Zahra explained to him that her mother was ill in the hospital. Li Yong listened and comforted Zahra, offering to go with her to the hospital the next day. Li Yong showed compassion to Zahra.

2. One day Shiori was walking in the countryside and saw a little lamb whose leg was caught in a fence. Shiori gently removed the leg and put a bandage on it. Shiori showed compassion to the lamb.

D. Story

When 'Abdu'l-Bahá traveled to the West, in every city He visited, many people came to see Him and listen to His encouraging words. Day and night He met with people of all kinds—the young and the old, the wealthy and the poor, officials and ordinary citizens. Some came out of their great love for the Master, and others came because they were curious about what He had to say.

One day a woman arrived at the home where the Master was staying and knocked on the door. She was an ordinary person who longed in her heart to spend a few moments with 'Abdu'l-Bahá. "Do you have an appointment to see the Master?" asked the man who opened the door. She said that she did not. In that case, she was told, it would not be possible for her to see 'Abdu'l-Bahá as He was meeting with some very important people. She turned away sadly and started walking down the steps in front of the house. What disappointment filled her heart! But suddenly a messenger from 'Abdu'l-Bahá appeared, asking her to return. The Master wished to see her. His voice was heard saying with power and authority, "A heart has been hurt. Hasten, hasten, bring her to me!"

E. Game: "Together"

Divide the children into pairs, standing side by side, with the left leg of one child tied to the right leg of the other. Explain to the children that, if they are to succeed in this game, they will have to learn to work together. Then have each pair walk from one designated spot to another. You can make the game more challenging by placing small obstacles in their path, such as branches and stones. Be sure to do this in a safe way. Alternatively, instead of simply walking, the pairs could be asked to jump like frogs, gallop like horses, and so on. It may be necessary to explain to the children that the pairs are not racing one another.

F. Coloring: Drawing 13

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 14

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

As always, you and a few of the students should recite some prayers to open the class. The children can then continue memorizing the prayer presented in the previous lesson.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

On the Wings of Detachment

CHORUS:

C F G
One day a bird was flying in the sky above
C F G
Full of joy and confidence
C F G C F G
Soaring in this Paradise, his home

C F G C F G
As he flew, his hunger began to grow
C F G C F G
So he turned to the water and clay below
C F
Down below
G C F
He was trapped
G C
By his desire
F G C F G
And his wings got covered in mud
C
Too heavy to fly,
F G C F G
He could not return to his home

(continued on next page)

Chorus

Like that bird I belong to the heavens
So I will not cling to the earth below
I will not cling to riches
I will not cling to my wishes
I will not cling to anything but God

C G F G
So I will walk on the feet of detachment

C G F G
I will soar on the wings of detachment

C G F
I will free myself of all attachment

G C
To anything but God *(repeat)*

C. Memorizing quotations

The children will memorize a quotation about the quality of detachment, which is the theme of the lesson. You can introduce the theme to them in the following way:

> God has created every good thing in this world for us to enjoy—good health, delicious foods, love and friendship, the beauty of nature, and the powers of the mind, which enable us to make discoveries and create inventions to improve the way we live. We should make use of all the bounties of God and be thankful to Him for the joy of living. But we should be careful not to become attached to this world. Our souls must be free at all times; like free and strong birds, they should soar in the heaven of holiness. How sad if a bird remains on the ground, unable to take flight because it is attached to the things around it. Let us memorize the following quotation:

"Know that thy true adornment consisteth in the love of God and in thy detachment from all save Him . . ."[115]

Consists

1. Vladislav has a sausage, some potatoes, and green beans for lunch. His lunch consists of sausage, potatoes, and green beans.

2. This sentence has five words. It consists of five words.

Detachment

1. Helgi really wanted to go swimming with his friends. However, he happily stayed home with his younger sister so that his mother could go to the store. Helgi showed detachment from his own plans because he wanted to help his family.

2. At the end of the school year, Anjali thought it would be nice to bring flowers to her teacher. Her sister suggested they bake a cake instead. Anjali thinks this is a nice idea. She is detached from her own idea.

All save

1. The children all did well on the examination, except one who did not study. All save one student did well on the test.

2. The mother wanted to make a special meal for the family. Then she realized that she could not do so because she did not have one important ingredient. She had all save one ingredient.

D. Story

One day two men, longtime friends, were discussing spiritual matters over tea. Now, one of these men had accumulated a great many riches during his life and wanted for nothing. The other had much less. "I would like to make a journey to the Holy Land," said the second to his wealthy friend. The first man replied without hesitation, "This is a wonderful idea! I will join you." The pair set down their teacups and arose at once, headed in the direction of the Holy Land.

They had been walking for only a short while when night began to fall. The poorer man slowed down and then stopped, saying, "My friend, let us return to our houses to pass the night. It will be more comfortable, and we can start afresh in the morning." "But why would we turn back?" the other replied. "We are on our way to the Holy Land!" Still, his friend was not satisfied. "The Holy Land is a long distance to travel by foot," he tried again. "At least let me go back and fetch my donkey, which I am reluctant to leave behind."

"Then," the wealthy friend said to the other, "perhaps you are not the one to accompany me on this journey after all. With joy, I have abandoned a great fortune—horses, lands, and fine clothes—but feel no sense of loss. For what greater bounty is there than to spend even a moment in the Holy Land. Are you not able to leave even your donkey behind?" Sadly, he could not let go of his one prized possession. And so he left his friend, who continued on his way to the Holy Land and never looked back once.

E. Game: "Wheel"

Ask the children to stand sideways in a circle and extend their left arms inward, joining hands at the center. They should now resemble a wheel, with their arms as its spokes. Next, have the children turn around the center of the circle like a wheel. After they have done so, ask them to move around the space where the class is being held, while turning in a circle and remaining in formation. To add to the challenge, they can try skipping and hopping.

You could make the game even more challenging by having the children sit on the floor in a circle and extend their legs straight out so that their feet touch in the middle. They should then place the palms of their hands on the floor beside their hips. They are now ready to get the wheel moving. To do so, they will all push themselves up with their hands and move one step to the right. They should continue step by step with their hands in this way, keeping their feet in the center of the wheel, until it makes a full rotation.

F. Coloring: Drawing 14

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 15

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After opening prayers have been recited, you can help the children continue memorizing the prayer introduced in Lesson 13.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Bestow Upon Me My Portion

CHORUS:

A
Bestow upon me my portion
D A
O Lord, O Lord
A D A
Bestow upon me my portion
E A
As it pleaseth Thee

A
It's easy to be content
D A
When things are going well
A
It's easy to be content
E A
When you're feeling swell
D A
But what is really more challenging
E A
Is to be content when things go wrong
D A
To be patient in times of difficulty
E A
Perhaps even sing a song

(continued on next page)

CHORUS

From the time He was a boy
The Master suffered indignities
From early in His life
He hardly had any comfort or ease
But He remained content and calm
Never full of anxiety
He trusted in God and accepted His Will
Continued on ever patiently

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

Below are some ideas that will help you present the theme of the lesson and the quotation the children will learn by heart.

> ‘Abdu’l-Bahá was content with the Will of God under all conditions. He used to tell those around Him that it is easy to be content when everything is going well, when one is healthy and living in comfort. What is more difficult is to feel happy and content in times of trouble, in times of illness and hardship. In spite of all the suffering that filled His life, ‘Abdu’l-Bahá never became disheartened. Through the most grave and difficult times, He remained content and thankful to God. He was always cheerful and optimistic. Let us memorize the following quotation so that we will often be reminded of the value of contentment with the Will of God:
>
> **“The source of all glory is acceptance of whatsoever the Lord hath bestowed, and contentment with that which God hath ordained.”[116]**

Glory

1. After studying science at school, Poh Leng joined a group of scientists. They made many important discoveries. Her work brought glory to her family’s name.

2. Swee loved to look at nature—at the mountains, the trees, and the sea. Whenever she saw the beauty of the world, she thought about the majesty and greatness of God, the Creator of all things. Looking at nature made Swee think of the glory of God.

Bestowed

1. Paulo thanks God every day for his loving family, his good health, and for all the good things God has given him. Paulo is grateful for the many gifts that God has bestowed on him.

2. Without the sun, the earth would be dark and cold, and nothing could live on it. The sun bestows light and warmth upon us.

Ordained

1. The king gave an order that all the people of his country should not work on the first day of spring. The first day of spring was ordained a holiday.

2. For many months there was no rain in the region, and the people were ordered by the village council to limit their use of water. The restrictions were ordained by the council in order to save water.

D. Story

One evening, 'Abdu'l-Bahá was walking with a few Bahá'ís in the bright city of London. They strolled along a street lined on both sides with glowing lamps that stretched as far as the eye could see. Those in the company of the beloved Master felt as though their hearts had been carried away to another world.

"I am very much pleased with this scene," 'Abdu'l-Bahá commented. "Light is good, most good. There was much darkness in the prison at 'Akká."

The small group of friends, who loved 'Abdu'l-Bahá, were saddened at the memory of His confinement in the fortress-city of 'Akká, where He had spent so many years as a prisoner alongside His Father, Bahá'u'lláh. It was a very unwelcoming place, and the family suffered great hardship. "We are glad, oh so full of gladness that you are free," they said.

To this 'Abdu'l-Bahá responded: "I was happy in that prison, for those days were passed in the path of service." The greatest prison, He told them, is the prison of self. You see, if we think only of ourselves and not of those around us—that is when we are really imprisoned, when we truly suffer! 'Abdu'l-Bahá was content at all times, for He walked in the path of service to God and humanity. And so, even during the darkest days as a prisoner in 'Akká, the light of His indomitable spirit shone forth, giving warmth and comfort to others.

E. Game: "Sculptor"

Pretend you are a sculptor and the children will help you make your piece of artwork. Ask a child to come to the front of the class and hold a pose that you will demonstrate—for example, bending over with arms outstretched. Then, one by one or a few at a time, call the other children to the front of the group and demonstrate poses for them to imitate. Once they all know their poses, have them come together and form the art piece. Then add yourself to the group as the final part.

You can continue the game by dividing your students into pairs. Have each pair take turns, with one pretending to be the sculptor and the other holding the poses requested.

You may be able to think of other variations of this game as well. For example, you could call out questions like "Can you be a fence?" or "Can you be a garden?" The children would then respond by arranging themselves into the desired formation.

F. Coloring: Drawing 15

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 16

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

By this class, the children should all be able to recite from memory the prayer introduced in Lesson 13, which you can review with them after opening devotions.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

We Are Drops

C
We are drops
We are drops *(echo voice)*

C
Of one ocean
Of one ocean

F
We are waves
We are waves

G
Of one sea
Of one sea

CHORUS:

C
Come and join us
Come and join us *(echo voice)*

F
In our quest for unity

C G C F C
It's a way of life for you and me

We are flowers *(echo voice)*
Of one garden
We are leaves
Of one tree

(continued on next page)

CHORUS

All the earth is *(echo voice)*
But one country
Man is one
Can't you see

CHORUS *(with last line repeated)*

C. Memorizing quotations

The ideas below will help you introduce the theme of the lesson, kindness, and the quotation that the children will memorize.

God created all of humanity to live together as one family. If we are to do this, we cannot let differences come between us. Instead, we should mingle with people of every religion, nation, and background with love and kindness in our hearts. To help us remember this, let us memorize the following quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:

"Blessed is he who mingleth with all men in a spirit of utmost kindliness and love."[117]

Mingle

1. Egrets and cowbirds are two kinds of birds that live in the meadows. They are often seen together. These two kinds of birds mingle.

2. In the devotional meeting, after the prayers were read, people stayed and mingled.

D. Story

You know from some of our earlier stories that, when 'Abdu'l-Bahá first arrived in 'Akká, many of the people treated Him badly. They were cruel to the Bahá'ís and did not want to speak to them. Soon, however, they came to see that the Bahá'ís were loving and kind, and slowly most of the townspeople began to show them kindness in return. But there were a few who clung to their anger and hatred.

Now, one day, a man who still carried much hatred in his heart towards 'Abdu'l-Bahá heard others praising His greatness and goodness. The man became outraged. He would show them, he said with anger, that this Person they all revered was not so wonderful after all. And off he went, his heart burning with anger. He knew that 'Abdu'l-Bahá could be found praying in the mosque at that hour, and he rushed there, ready to lay violent hands upon the beloved Master. But 'Abdu'l-Bahá looked at the man with serenity and dignity. Lovingly, He reminded him of the teachings of God that we are to be generous to all guests, even those that are different from us. At this, the man realized that 'Abdu'l-Bahá and the Bahá'ís were, indeed, like guests in 'Akká, his home. And, like a generous host, he should welcome them with love and treat them with kindness.

E. Game: "The Hidden Quality"

Tell the children to form a circle, with their two hands cupped together in front of them. Stand in the middle of the circle, holding a small object like a pebble. The object will represent a quality, for instance, "kindness". As you walk along the circle, pass your hand over the hands of each child and say, for example, "John is kind," "Isabella is kind," "Dervi is kind," and so on. Each child should close his or her hands, acting as though you have given him or her the object. You should actually leave the item in the hands of one of the children. When you have gone around the entire circle, one child should try to guess who has the object by saying, for example, "Kenji is very kind." Then Kenji should open his hands and show whether or not he has it. The child should be given three tries to guess who has the object, after which the game can be repeated using another quality. You should make sure that each child is given the object in at least one round.

F. Coloring: Drawing 16

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 17

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

Over the next four lessons, the children will be learning to recite the prayer below by heart, and they will find it a source of encouragement if you open each class period with a new one that you have committed to memory, such as the one suggested in Section 16. After a few students have joined you in saying opening prayers, you can introduce this one in the usual way.

> **"Thy name is my healing, O my God, and remembrance of Thee is my remedy. Nearness to Thee is my hope, and love for Thee is my companion. Thy mercy to me is my healing and my succor in both this world and the world to come. Thou, verily, art the All-Bountiful, the All-Knowing, the All-Wise."[118]**

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Source of Courage

CHORUS:

Am
The source of courage and power
Dm E Am
Is the promotion of the Word of God
Am
The source of courage and power
Dm E Am
Is steadfastness in His love

(continued on next page)

G
Forget about yourself

C
Stand up for what is right

E7
Defend those in need

Am
Rely upon His might

Teach the Word of God
Be courageous in your deeds
Follow His path
To happiness it leads

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

The following statement will assist you in presenting the theme of the lesson and the quotation for memorization:

> To have courage means to stand for what is right even if we are the only ones who do so, to defend those who need our help even if it causes us discomfort, and to tell the truth even when we know it may lead to difficulties for us. It takes courage to face hardships in life with calm and grace. We draw courage from our love of God and our desire to please Him above all others. To help us remember that we should face every situation in life with courage, let us memorize the following quotation:
>
> **"The source of courage and power is the promotion of the Word of God, and steadfastness in His Love."[119]**

Source

1. Kyongmi lives in a village in a valley. The melting snow from the top of nearby mountains provides water to the village. The source of the village's water is snow from the mountaintops.

2. Mrs. Putters has three loving and well-behaved children. Her children are a source of joy and happiness to her.

Promotion

1. Two of Shoa's friends started an argument and became angry with each other. Shoa helped each to see the other's point of view and make peace. Shoa always promotes peace and understanding among his friends.

2. A nurse visits the classroom to teach the children about foods that are good for their health. The nurse promotes healthy eating.

Steadfastness

1. Promilla knew that she wanted to be a doctor. She always studied hard in school, and after many years of difficult work, she achieved her goal. She was steadfast in her efforts to become a doctor.

2. Zvondai went to a very remote village to help open a new school. Although he missed his family and faced many difficulties, he showed steadfastness and stayed in the village for many years, training teachers and working with children.

D. Story

'Alí-'Askar was a merchant in Persia. When he became a Bahá'í, he experienced much hardship at the hands of those who opposed the Faith. Within a short span of time, he had lost all he had. Even so, 'Alí-'Askar was not dispirited. Seeing that he would not be able to make a living in his homeland, he decided to move to Adrianople, a city in a neighboring country.

In Adrianople, though he still had little, he managed to acquire a small amount of merchandise. Before he was able to sell a single item, however, he was attacked by thieves who took everything he had in his possession, leaving him with nothing once again.

Not long after, the thieves were arrested, and the great fortune they had acquired from robbing many people was seized. One of the local authorities, dazzled by the riches, came up with an idea to keep the fortune for himself. He called 'Alí-'Askar to his office and explained.

"'Alí-'Askar," he said, "these thieves are very rich. In my report to the government, I wrote that the amount robbed from you was great. Therefore you must attend the trial and testify that what I have written is true." This way, the official thought, all of the money would be returned to 'Alí-'Askar, and the two would split it between themselves.

'Alí-'Askar knew that he could never go along with such a plan. "Your Honor, Khán," he replied, "the goods stolen from me amounted to very little. How can I report something that is not true? When they question me, I will give the facts exactly as they are. I consider this my duty, and only this."

The official tried again to convince 'Alí-'Askar. "We have a golden opportunity here," the official said. "You and I can both profit by it. Don't let such a once-in-a-lifetime chance slip through your fingers!"

But 'Alí-'Askar again refused, saying, "Khán, how would I answer to God? Let me be. I shall tell the truth and nothing but the truth."

Now the official became angry. If 'Alí-'Askar did not go along with his scheme, all his planning would come to naught, and he would lose the great fortune now within his grasp. And so he began to threaten 'Alí-'Askar, hoping he could frighten him

into cooperating. "I will jail you," he said. "I will have you banished; there is not a torment I will spare you." Then he told 'Alí-'Askar that, if he did not agree, he would send him back to Persia.

'Alí-'Askar only smiled. "Jináb-i-Khán," he said, "do with me as you please; I will not turn my back on what is right."

E. Game: "Yes or No"

Begin the game by asking the children to form a wide circle, with you in the center. Now explain to the children that you are going to make several statements. Some of them will be correct; others will be incorrect. Tell them that, if the statement is correct, they should shout out "yes" and hop towards the center of the circle. If it is incorrect, they should shout out "no" and hop backwards.

All the statements you make should be based on things the children can readily observe. Examples of "yes" statements are as follows: "The sun gives off light." "Trees grow from seeds." "Mountains are tall." You could also make statements that describe what the children are wearing, like "Sera is wearing a blue shirt," or what they see in the space around them, like "There are two benches over there."

A few examples of "no" statements are: "Rain falls upward." "Fish fly." "Stones walk on feet." Again, you could draw on your surroundings to make incorrect statements. Remember that you should have more correct statements than incorrect ones so that, by the end of the game, the children reach you at the center of the circle.

F. Coloring: Drawing 17

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 18

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After opening devotions, the children should spend time learning to recite from memory the prayer introduced in the last lesson.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Be Hopeful

C F
The future we can never know
G C
What will happen the next day

(continued on next page)

C F
Yet bounties never cease to flow

G C
Trust in God and make your way

CHORUS:

F G
Be hopeful, be hopeful

C F
And find God's bounties everywhere

F
The sun will rise

G
And fill the skies

C F
Look up with expectant eyes

F G C
Look to Him with hopeful eyes

Be ever hopeful, strive to grow
And winter will give way to spring
His bounties never cease to flow
They're bringing life to everything

CHORUS

Be a source of joy and peace
Serve and let the spirit glow
Remember bounties never cease
Be hopeful for tomorrow

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

Below are some ideas you can use to introduce the quotation that the children will memorize in this class.

> God's love is always with us. He will never leave us alone and promises to help us throughout our lives. Though we do not know what will happen from one day to the next, we trust in God and remember that His gifts and bounties are all around us. And so we are hopeful when we look to the future, confident that we will receive a share of His infinite blessings. With hearts full of hope, we constantly anticipate

the outpouring of God's bounties upon us. To help us remember the importance of hopefulness, let us memorize these words of 'Abdu'l-Bahá:

"Never lose thy trust in God. Be thou ever hopeful, for the bounties of God never cease to flow upon man."[120]

Trust

1. Edward had a problem and went to Hung Wei for help. Edward knows that Hung Wei will do all he can to help him. Edward trusts Hung Wei.

2. Nirmala wants to repair the roof of her house but cannot do it alone. Nirmala's friends offer to come the next day to help her. She trusts they will come as promised and gets everything ready.

Hopeful

1. Iosefina plants a seed in a sunny spot and waters it every day. She looks forward to seeing it grow. Iosefina is hopeful the seed will one day become a strong plant.

2. Antonio's good friend Mattias moved to another town. Antonio missed his friend, but he was hopeful that they would see each other again soon.

Bounties

1. Every night when Lilian prays, she thinks about the many things she is fortunate to have. She thinks about her parents, her friends, her teachers, and even the bed in which she sleeps. Lilian is always thankful for the bounties she has been given.

2. Reza has many friends and relatives who love him and help him grow. Reza is grateful for the bounty of their love and support.

Cease

1. When Tahir turns off the tap, the water stops coming out; the water ceases to flow.

2. Even on cloudy days, the rays of the sun warm the earth. The sun's rays never cease to reach the earth.

D. Story

There was once a man with no home, who lived alone on the banks of the River Thames in London. He was very sad and had lost all hope for happiness in life. One day, he walked past a shop and a photograph in a newspaper caught his eye. It was the face of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. The man stood frozen, staring at the face. He had never seen 'Abdu'l-Bahá before and did not know who He was, but he was certain that he must meet Him. The address of a house was given in the newspaper, so the man started walking, hoping to find Him there. It was a very long distance—nearly fifty kilometers—but he kept walking until he reached the house.

The man was tired and hungry when at last he arrived, and the lady of the house kindly invited him in, gave him some food, and let him rest for a while. As he rested, he told his story to the woman and then asked her whether 'Abdu'l-Bahá was there. The woman assured him that He was.

"Will He see me?" he asked. "Even me?"

Just as the woman replied that she was certain 'Abdu'l-Bahá would see him, the Master Himself appeared at the door. The man stood up, and 'Abdu'l-Bahá stretched out His arms to greet him. It was as though the man was an old friend whom 'Abdu'l-Bahá had long been expecting. He welcomed him with love and compassion and asked him to sit down next to Him.

Then 'Abdu'l-Bahá, who always knew how to bring lost joy back to people's hearts, began to speak to the man. He encouraged him to let go of his sadness, reminding him that he was rich in the Kingdom of God! As 'Abdu'l-Bahá showered the man with compassion, His comforting words began to heal his heart and give him strength. Little by little his sadness drifted away. Before he departed, the man told 'Abdu'l-Bahá that he would not let his poverty bring him sadness anymore; instead he would find work in the fields and save his money so that he could buy a bit of land, on which he would grow violets to sell in the market. The man learned from 'Abdu'l-Bahá to put his trust in God and to have confidence that God would confirm and bless his efforts. His despair turned into hope.

E. Game: "Rainmaker"

First have the children stand in a circle around you, and then introduce the game by asking them to imagine they are in the desert longing for rain. Start rubbing the palms of your hands together and tell the children that, when you look at each one, they should begin to do the same. Once you have gone around the full circle and all the children are rubbing their palms, tell them to keep going until you look at each one with a new motion, which they should imitate. Snap your fingers as the next motion and then clap your hands as the next, followed by slapping your thighs and then stomping your feet. The sound made by all the children together should resemble the first few sprinkles of rain in the beginning and a great thunderstorm at the end.

F. Coloring: Drawing 18

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 19

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

As always, open the class with prayers. You can then help the children continue memorizing the one introduced in Lesson 17.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Busy Hands

CHORUS:

C F
Busy hands make happy children

C G
Happy children can be found

C F
Making other people happy

C F G C
Spreading peace and love around

C F
Working hands to build a new world

C G
Everybody has a role

C F
All of us can be so thankful

C F G C
For we soon shall reach our goal

CHORUS

God will help us build a new world
Where we all help someone else
All of us will love our neighbour
More than we love our own selves

CHORUS *(with last line repeated)*

C. Memorizing quotations

In this lesson, the children will memorize a quotation about trustworthiness, and you could introduce this theme in the following way:

> One of the greatest qualities in the sight of God is trustworthiness. A trustworthy person is truthful and honest and can be counted on to keep his or her word. We should not say one thing but do another. Our actions should always reflect our words. When we are trustworthy, others can be sure that we will do our best to fulfill our responsibilities and carry out our duties. In this way, people are able to work together

in harmony, knowing that everyone will do his or her part. To help us remember the importance of trustworthiness, let us memorize the following quotation:

"Trustworthiness is the greatest portal leading unto the tranquility and security of the people."[121]

Trustworthiness

1. Athos promised his mother that he would help her to prepare dinner. When his friends came to his house to invite him to play outside, Athos remembered the promise he had made to his mother and told his friends he would play with them another time. Athos showed the quality of trustworthiness.

2. Sunita went to the store to pick up some things for her family, but she found she had not brought enough money to pay for everything they needed. She asked the store's owner if she could bring the rest of the money the next day. The owner said this was fine because she knew Sunita was trustworthy and would pay for the items as promised.

Tranquility

1. Whenever Emilio has to make an important decision, he tries to find a quiet place to think and meditate. He goes to a quiet garden nearby. In its tranquility, he is able to clear his mind and heart.

2. Once the great storm had passed, everything became unusually quiet and still. Peace and tranquility followed the storm.

Security

1. When a baby animal is frightened, it will often run back to its mother for safety. The mother provides security to her young ones.

2. The hiker went off the trail and got lost in the woods. When he did not return, the guides from the village went out to look for him. He felt a sense of security when they found him, knowing that they would lead him back to safety.

D. Story

Years ago, in the early days of the Faith, there were only a small number of Bahá'ís, spread out over several countries. They faced many challenges and often wrote to 'Abdu'l-Bahá in the Holy Land with news and questions. Their letters traveled over long distances before reaching Him, and He would answer each one with great love and care. His words of encouragement strengthened them and cheered their hearts. And so it was crucial that this stream of communication not be disrupted.

Now, there lived in the area at the time a Bahá'í by the name of Muḥammad-Taqí. He had come from Persia many years earlier as a young man and had established a small business. Gradually he became known for his unwavering reliability. So dependable was he that all the mail for 'Abdu'l-Bahá in the Holy Land and the responses sent

abroad passed through the home of Muḥammad-Taqí. Everyone knew that he could be trusted to make sure each piece of mail was delivered promptly and securely.

But, then, the enemies of the Faith rose up against 'Abdu'l-Bahá. They became jealous of the love and respect people showed to Him. They hoped they could bring about His exile, or worse still, His execution. Spies were planted all around His house, and He was kept under constant watch. How pleased His enemies would have been if they could have stopped the flow of correspondence and broken the link between 'Abdu'l-Bahá and the devoted Bahá'ís in other countries; how much more if they could have stolen some document that could be used to mislead the authorities!

'Abdu'l-Bahá, however, was not deterred. He could often be seen late into the night, writing by the light of His lamp; for He had ensured a secure means for the receipt and dispatch of mail. What do you think He did?

You see, 'Abdu'l-Bahá knew His enemies recognized the important work Muḥammad-Taqí carried out. They would no doubt try to intercept the mail routed through him. So 'Abdu'l-Bahá sent Muḥammad-Taqí to a nearby place in a neighboring country, where he was out of danger. Then others, whom His enemies did not suspect, carried in and out of the Holy Land all the mail to Muḥammad-Taqí. And, from this safe spot, he continued to faithfully receive and dispatch mail, never faltering in the trust 'Abdu'l-Bahá had placed in him. So it was that, even in the most difficult times, communication with the Holy Land was never cut off and guidance continued to reach friends in the most remote places.

E. Game: "A Guide"

Divide your students into pairs and ask them to hold hands with their partner. Blindfold one child in each pair and have the other child lead him or her around, making sure he or she does not stumble along the way. For an added challenge, the blindfolded child can be guided around obstacles such as tree trunks, ditches, rocks, and tires. Once a bond of trust has been established between partners in this way, the blindfolded child can be guided using verbal instructions alone. In that case, the guide should follow close behind in order to catch the child should he or she stumble.

As an alternative to the above game, all the children can be blindfolded and form a train, led by you or one of the students.

F. Coloring: Drawing 19

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 20

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After you and a few students have said opening devotions, review with the children the prayer they have been learning over the last three lessons.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Kindling the Fire of God's Love

D
In my heart

A
There is a flame

G
That God has placed

D
A special flame

A
This is the fire

G
The fire

D
Of His love

CHORUS:

D A
I will pray
I will pray *(echo voice)*

G
To God

A D A
To kindle in my heart
To kindle in my heart *(echo voice)*

G
That flame

A D A
The fire of His love

G
And I will strive

A D
That its light illumines all hearts

Day by day
I will feed this flame
As I pray

(continued on next page)

And do good unto others
This flame will grow
As I pray
And serve mankind

And as this flame burns
As it grows
It will be felt
By all who come
Its way
It will bring warmth
To all
Who come its way

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

The theme of this lesson is enkindlement, and the following statement will help you introduce this theme and the quotation for memorization:

> Every human being was created to know God and to love Him, and we all have the spark of His love in our hearts. It is important for us to feed the flame of the love of God by praying to Him daily and by serving others, that it may grow stronger and stronger. As this flame burns ever brighter in our hearts, its warmth will be felt by all who cross our path. And their hearts, too, will be set aglow. When we are so enkindled, we become like burning candles that cannot help but to give light and warmth to those around us. Let us memorize the following quotation:

> **"Be ye enkindled, O people, with the heat of the love of God, that ye may enkindle the hearts of others."[122]**

Enkindle

1. The house was cold, so Axel's father decided to start a fire. He put large logs in the stove and lit some small twigs below. The wood soon became enkindled, and the fire warmed the room.

2. A scientist came to the school and explained to the students many interesting things about the workings of the universe. They began to ask her various questions after the talk. She had enkindled in the students a desire to know more about the world.

D. Story

> *Thomas Breakwell was a young man who held an important position in a cotton mill in the southern United States and spent his vacations in Europe. On his way to Europe in the summer of 1901, he met a woman on a steamship and began talking with her about spiritual subjects. When they arrived in Paris, the woman took him*

along to meet a friend of hers who lived in an apartment in the city and who, she knew, had similar interests. The young woman welcomed them, and the three talked for some time. Before leaving, Breakwell asked his hostess whether he might return to speak further. He was invited to come back the next morning.

When he arrived the next day, the young woman noticed that his eyes were shining brightly and his voice was full of emotion. She asked him to be seated. Breakwell looked at her intently for a moment and then described for her a strange experience. After he had left her home the day before, he had walked along an avenue, alone, in the warm and heavy evening air. Not a leaf stirred around him. Then, all of a sudden, a great wind came that seemed to bring with it the glad tidings of a new message from God!

The young woman urged him to be calm. You see, she knew of the message to which Breakwell referred. During the next three days, over the course of many hours, she told him everything she could about the Bahá'í Faith—its history and its teachings—and about 'Abdu'l-Bahá, the perfect Exemplar of those teachings, Who was living in the prison-city of 'Akká in the Holy Land.

By the end of three days, Breakwell's heart was so filled with joy and hope that he wanted nothing other than to travel to 'Akká and visit 'Abdu'l-Bahá. It happened that there was another young man who had already made plans to go to the Holy Land for this very purpose and who was most pleased to have Breakwell accompany him. So, a message was sent to 'Abdu'l-Bahá requesting permission for him to come, and in a short time, they were on their way.

When the two men arrived at 'Abdu'l-Bahá's home, they were taken into a room where several other men were gathered. Looking around, Breakwell became deeply troubled. There was no one in the room to whom his heart was drawn, and thinking that 'Abdu'l-Bahá must be among those present, he feared that he had failed to recognize that Heavenly Being about Whom he had learned in Paris. He sat down in despair. At that moment, a door opened, and Breakwell looked up. He saw there a brilliant light, from which the figure of 'Abdu'l-Bahá emerged. He immediately knew that his dearest wish had been fulfilled.

Breakwell spent two glorious days in the presence of 'Abdu'l-Bahá, during which the fire that had been enkindled in his heart grew stronger and stronger. When Breakwell told 'Abdu'l-Bahá about his job at the cotton mill, where children were used as workers, 'Abdu'l-Bahá advised him to resign from his post, which he did without hesitation. At the end of his visit, he returned to Paris, his spirit ablaze. For the rest of his short life, he burned like a bright candle, sharing the light enkindled in his heart with everyone he met. Upon his passing, 'Abdu'l-Bahá revealed a Tablet in his honor, which includes the following verse: "O Breakwell, O my dear one! Thou hast lit a flame within the lamp of the Company on high, thou hast set foot in the Abhá Paradise, thou hast found a shelter in the shadow of the Blessed Tree, thou hast attained His meeting in the haven of Heaven."

E. Game: "Help the Sick"

Choose one child to pretend to be the "sick patient". Now have two other children stand face to face, their hands clasped around one another's forearms, in order to make a

"chair". Depending on the size and skill of the children, you could have them form a chair in another manner. In that case, have both children clasp their own right wrists with their left hands and the left wrists of one another with their right hands.

The other classmates should now help the "sick friend" into the chair. Select a tree or another spot as the "health center" and ask the two children forming the chair to carry the "sick" child there.

With a larger group, the children can be asked to form a "stretcher" instead of a chair by standing in two lines facing each other. They should bend their arms at the elbows, with each one grasping the forearms of the child across from him or her. The "sick" child should then lie on the stretcher to be carried to the "health center". Remind the children that everyone will have to work together if they are to get the "patient" safely to the health center. "If we let the sick person fall," you could say, "he or she will get hurt, and we will all feel sad. But if we arrive at the health center without any problems, we can feel happy and content because we will have helped our friend."

F. Coloring: Drawing 20

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 21

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

For this and the next three lessons, recite a prayer you know by heart to open each class period, such as the one suggested in Section 19. After you and a few of the children have said opening devotions, you can present to them the prayer below, the final one they will memorize in this grade.

> **"O Thou kind Lord! I am a little child, exalt me by admitting me to the kingdom. I am earthly, make me heavenly; I am of the world below, let me belong to the realm above; gloomy, suffer me to become radiant; material, make me spiritual, and grant that I may manifest Thine infinite bounties.**
>
> **"Thou art the Powerful, the All-Loving."[123]**

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Radiance

E A
As we reflect the light that shines from above
B E
Our hearts will radiate with kindness and love

(continued on next page)

E A
As we are joyful, illumined and bright

B E
All those around will feel the warmth of His light

CHORUS:

E A
O Son! O Son of Being!

B E
Thou art My lamp and My light is in thee!

E A
O Son! O Son of Being!

B E
Thou art My lamp and My light is in thee!

The love of God never ceases to flow
As we arise to serve its brightness will grow
Don't hesitate! Just radiate! With all of your might
Till each and every heart is filled with His light

CHORUS *(with last line repeated)*

C. Memorizing quotations

In this lesson the children will memorize a quotation related to the quality of radiance, which you can introduce in the following way:

> The light of the love of God never ceases to illumine our hearts. As this light grows brighter and brighter, our hearts become radiant with His love. The light of the knowledge of God—the knowledge of His greatness, of His glory—brightens our eyes. And, through our generous deeds and kind words, the light of love and knowledge shines forth. Those around us are touched by the radiance of our joy. To help us remember the importance of the quality of radiance, let us memorize the following quotation:

> **"O Son of Being! Thou art My lamp and My light is in thee. Get thou from it thy radiance and seek none other than Me."[124]**

Radiance

1. When Tyrell woke up, the room was filled with sunshine. He was happy to be greeted by the radiance of the sun.

2. Mrs. Santos loves everyone like her own family. She is always generous, kind and helpful towards others. The love in her heart is felt by all the people she meets, bringing them joy. Everyone is touched by her radiance.

Seek

1. When a baby bird hatches, the mother will look for food to feed it. The mother bird will seek food for the new chick.

2. The school invited all the students on a special outing. In order to attend, they needed their parents' permission. All the students were asked to seek approval from their parents to go on the outing.

D. Story

Dorothy Baker, about whom you will probably learn more one day, had the honor of meeting 'Abdu'l-Bahá as a young girl. It was Dorothy's grandmother who took her to meet 'Abdu'l-Bahá during His travels in the West. Arriving at a house that she had never visited before, Dorothy entered a crowded room. Many people were talking quietly and reverently while waiting for 'Abdu'l-Bahá to speak. The Master smiled as Dorothy and her grandmother came in and motioned to the young girl to sit near Him. Eager, but with some trepidation, she made her way across the room. Without looking up from the floor, she carefully walked past all the other guests to reach the footstool near His feet.

As 'Abdu'l-Bahá began to speak, Dorothy sat with her eyes cast down, staring at her black shoes. She did not have the courage to look at Him. But soon her fear was gone. She felt attracted to the warmth of 'Abdu'l-Bahá's loving presence. His radiance was magnetic. Without even realizing that she had moved, Dorothy found herself turned in His direction, with her elbows on her knees and her chin in her hands, gazing up at 'Abdu'l-Bahá's luminous face.

Dorothy could never remember what 'Abdu'l-Bahá spoke about that day. All she could remember was His kind face, His melodious voice, and the warmth of His presence. His loving eyes seemed to tell her of the spiritual worlds of God. In time, the love of God that had been ignited in her heart grew so strong that she decided to write to 'Abdu'l-Bahá. She begged Him that she might be allowed to serve Him and the Cause of His Father, Bahá'u'lláh. In His answer to Dorothy, 'Abdu'l-Bahá praised her goal, assured her of God's bounties, and expressed the hope that she would succeed in her desire. And, indeed, Dorothy dedicated her entire life to serving God and humanity.

E. Game: "Two-Way Copy"

Divide the children into pairs, each child facing his or her partner. Now ask one child in each pair to begin making simple physical movements, which the other child should try to mirror. After a few minutes, the partners can switch roles. You can also have them mirror facial expressions rather than movements. Next, have one child in each pair stand behind the other. As the one in the front moves, the one behind should shadow his or her movements.

F. Coloring: Drawing 21

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 22

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

After opening devotions, the children can continue memorizing the prayer introduced in the last lesson.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

I Want to Be Happy

Am
There is something you must know
Am E7
In this Faith we have to show
Dm
We are men of deeds, not of words
Am E7 Am
Our very life should show our Faith to friend and foe

CHORUS:

Am
I want to be happy
Am
I want to be strong
Am
To be His servant
Am
My whole life long
Dm Am
So, I must obey the laws of God
E7 Am
Yes, I must obey the laws of God

There is something you must know
In this world of pomp and show
People are tired of empty speech
They want to see you practice what you teach

CHORUS

C. Memorizing quotations

The children will learn to recite the quotation below by heart in this lesson, which is focused on the theme of faithfulness. Here are some ideas to assist you in introducing it:

> A faithful soul never forgets all the bounties that God has bestowed on it; it never ceases to love God. It is out of our faithfulness to Him that we always try our very best to follow His teachings and obey His laws, even when it becomes difficult. So it is that we work hard to serve others and to do worthy deeds, with no other thought than to attain His good pleasure. For the faithful soul there is no greater joy than striving to please God. Let us memorize this quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:
>
> **"Happy is the faithful one who is attired with the vesture of high endeavor and hath arisen to serve this Cause."[125]**

Attired

1. Mae has a beautiful dress that she only wears on special occasions. She put on her dress for the community gathering. Mae was attired in her special dress.

2. Natalia is kind to everyone. God has attired her soul with kindness.

Vesture

1. In some places, judges must wear a white wig and a long black robe in a court of law. They must wear the full vesture of judges.

2. Before leaving the palace, the prince puts on his sash and crown. He puts on his royal vesture.

3. Jakob says prayers every morning before leaving the house. The prayers are like a vesture clothing his soul. They strengthen and protect him throughout the day.

Endeavor

1. The students decided to plant trees around the school. The community supported their endeavor by providing seedlings and soil.

2. Pierre and Arlene decided that they would climb to the top of the mountain. They knew that this would be a difficult endeavor, but they were determined to try.

D. Story

> *When 'Abdu'l-Bahá was a young boy, His family, which was part of the nobility of Persia, had a servant by the name of Isfandíyár. He was very loyal to the family, and they trusted him a great deal. When the authorities, out of jealousy and ignorance, had 'Abdu'l-Bahá's beloved Father, Bahá'u'lláh, arrested, all of the family's possessions were taken away. They were left with nothing, and anyone close to Bahá'u'lláh was in danger. Still, Isfandíyár continued to look after the family. Knowing that many officers would be looking for Isfandíyár, 'Abdu'l-Bahá's mother urged him to leave the city. But Isfandíyár would not leave.*

"I cannot go," he said, explaining that he owed money to many shopkeepers for items he had purchased. "How can I go?" he asked. "They will say that the servant of Bahá'u'lláh has bought and consumed the goods and supplies of the storekeepers without paying for them. Unless I pay all these obligations, I cannot go. But if they take me, never mind. If they punish me, there is no harm in that. If they kill me, do not be grieved. But to go away is impossible. I must remain until I pay all I owe."

For one month Isfandíyár went about in the streets and bazaars, selling small things he owned. When he had paid every last debt, he went to the family and said goodbye, for he knew he could stay with them no longer. A government minister agreed to take him in and to protect and shelter him during this dangerous time.

Many months later, Bahá'u'lláh was released from prison, and He and His family were exiled from Persia by the authorities. They went to Baghdád, a city in the neighboring country. Isfandíyár, ever faithful to Bahá'u'lláh, journeyed to Baghdád to ask whether he could once again serve in His household. Bahá'u'lláh said to him, "When you left us, there was a Persian minister who gave you a place to stay when no one else could give you protection. Because he gave you shelter and protected you, you must be faithful to him. If he is satisfied to have you go, then come to us; but if he does not want you to go, do not leave him."

Of course, Isfandíyár was so upright, so trustworthy and loyal, that the minister did not want him to go. "O Isfandíyár!" he exclaimed. "I am not willing that you should go, yet, if you wish to go, let it be according to your own will." But Isfandíyár remembered Bahá'u'lláh's words. He remained in the minister's service until, sometime later, the minister passed away and Isfandíyár once again returned to the family he so loved, serving 'Abdu'l-Bahá to the end of his days.

E. Game: "Who Is Knocking at My Door?"

Blindfold one of the children, who should be seated on a bench with his or her back to the rest of the class. Now point to another child. He or she should go up to the blindfolded child and knock on the bench. The child who is seated should say, "Who is knocking at my door?" The other, trying to disguise his or her voice, will respond, "It's me!" The seated child will then try to guess who is knocking. He or she will have three guesses, after which another child should be given a turn. You may wish to mention to the children that, if the blindfolded child is to listen carefully, the rest of the class will need to remain very quiet.

F. Coloring: Drawing 22

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 23

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

You can open the class with prayers and then help the children advance in their efforts to memorize the prayer introduced in Lesson 21.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Patience

D A
Your legs are getting tired
A D
And the road is very long, long, long
D A
You want to give up trying
A D
And the sun is beating strong
G D
No sense gettin' impatient
G D
It's useless if you cry
G D
If you take it step by step
A D
The time goes rushing by

CHORUS:

G D
Patience is the answer
G D
When you're sad and blue
G D
Patience is rewarded
A D
It brings happiness to you

Your brother doesn't understand
But you've explained it more than twice
You really ought to try again
And do your best to be nice
No sense gettin' impatient
It's useless to be stern
If you show him kindness
It's the way to help him learn

(continued on next page)

Chorus

You want to do much better
But still you don't succeed
You wonder why make an effort
And where it all will lead
No sense gettin' impatient
It's silly to do less
If you keep on striving
You'll eventually progress

Chorus

C. Memorizing quotations

In this lesson, the children will memorize a quotation related to patience, which you can present in the following way:

> Patience is one of the most important qualities we can possess. Without patience we can achieve little in this life. In our studies, in our work, in our family, in our friendships with others, in our efforts to grow spiritually, patience is necessary. Not all things in life can be done quickly. Many things can only be done little by little, day after day. When we exercise patience, we do not try to hurry those things that require time. We need to be patient with others and ourselves, because we are all learning and growing. To help us in our efforts to acquire patience, let us memorize the following quotation:

"He, verily, shall increase the reward of them that endure with patience."[126]

Reward

1. Mrs. Anderson was very pleased with the excellent science projects that the students in her class prepared. As a reward, she took them to visit a nearby aquarium.

2. Alena spent time every day learning how to play the guitar. When she played a sweet song for her younger brother, the joy on his face was all the reward she needed for her efforts.

Endure

1. Aliya and her family moved to a faraway place. For the first few months, they had many difficulties. But, with the help of their kind neighbors, they were able to endure these difficulties and are now very happy in their new home.

2. Hugh became ill. He was in a great deal of pain, but did not complain. He endured his suffering with patience.

D. Story

Li Xin was very fond of peaches. Every day, he would bring a peach with him to school and eat it during his lunch break. He enjoyed every bite, but he always threw away the pit, with the seed inside.

One day, Li Xin's class was learning about seeds. This gave Li Xin an idea. He would plant a seed from his peach and help it grow into a tree! At lunchtime, he saved the pit from his peach and wrapped it in a piece of paper. When school ended, he raced home and asked his father to help him find a place to start growing his tree. His father reminded him that he would have to wait for the pit to dry before he could get the seed out. Still, Li Xin wanted to plant the pit right away. "Li Xin," said his father, "if you don't have the patience to dry the pit, how will you have the patience to wait for the seed to sprout?" So Li Xin set the pit out to dry.

A few days later, Li Xin was finally able to crack the pit and pull out the seed. His mother showed him a corner of the yard where the tree could grow big and tall. Li Xin dug a small hole and dropped in the seed, then covered it with a mound of moist earth. He grinned with excitement. His tree was finally on its way!

Every day, Li Xin would visit the mound, hoping to see some sign that the seed had sprouted. But no sprout appeared for weeks, and Li Xin grew disheartened. Seeing Li Xin's concern, his mother asked him what was wrong. "My seed is not growing," Li Xin said. "I wonder if I will ever have a tree." "Well," said his mother, "this seed has a lot of growing to do. In that way it is very much like you. When you were born, you were just a tiny little thing and all you did was eat and sleep. And now look at you! You are a young boy, walking, talking, and thinking for yourself! This tree may take many years to grow, but, if you care for it well, then someday you will be able to sit in its shade and enjoy its fruit." Thinking of this, Li Xin grew hopeful again. He knew from his class that a seed had to go through many changes before it could even become a sprout.

Then, one spring day, Li Xin went out to visit the mound, as he always did, and to his great excitement he saw a tiny green sprout poking up through the earth! His tree was growing! He ran to his neighbor, who was a farmer, and told her the exciting news. She gave him advice on how to care for the tree while it was so young and vulnerable, and he listened to her every word, eager to nurture it as best he could. "Soon I will have many peaches to give you as thanks for your good advice," said Li Xin. But the neighbor just smiled. "Li Xin, do you remember how you had to be patient while you waited for the pit to dry?" Li Xin nodded. "And do you remember how you needed even more patience while you waited for your seed to sprout?" Li Xin remembered this, too. "Well," said the neighbor, "it will take even longer before your sapling becomes a tree and sometime after that before it gives fruit. It could be years before the tree is ready to produce any peaches for you to enjoy."

And so Li Xin cared for the tree and tended to its needs as it grew from a sprout to a sapling and from a sapling to a tree. Little by little, it grew taller and broader, just as he did. And then one day, as Li Xin returned from school, he saw the tree's first peaches beginning to emerge where only blossoms had been before. Once again, he felt the joy that filled his heart when the seed had first sprouted. And once again he

knew that he would have to exercise patience. For it would be some time still before the peaches would be ripe and ready to eat.

E. Game: "Find the Starter"

Blindfold one child and have him or her turn away from the rest of the group. Then point silently to another child who will be the "starter". Before asking the first child to rejoin the group, help the others practice following the actions given by the "starter". For example, if he or she claps, everyone else should do the same. If he or she starts waving goodbye, so should all the others. The first child can now remove the blindfold and join the group again. He or she must look carefully and try to discover who is acting as the "starter". At the same time, the others should try hard not to look at the child leading the actions too closely or too often, which could easily give him or her away. The children can take turns being the "starter" or the one who guesses.

F. Coloring: Drawing 23

G. Closing prayers

LESSON 24

A. Reciting and memorizing prayers

As always, open the class with prayers and then review with the children the one they have been learning to say by heart over the past few lessons.

B. Songs (including a review of previous songs)

Firm in the Love of God

G C
We walk, we walk
D G
We walk the path of God
G C
We're firm, we're firm
D G
Firm in our love of God
G C
We walk the path of God
D G
When troubles come our way

(continued on next page)

G C
We're firm in our love of God

D G
And on His path we stay

We serve, we serve
We serve the Cause of God
We're firm, we're firm
Firm in our love of God
We serve the Cause of God
Always doing our part
We're firm in our love of God
And serve with a joyful heart

We stand, we stand
We stand, hearts turned towards God
We're firm, we're firm
Firm in our love of God
We stand, hearts turned towards God
Never doubting His aid
We're firm in our love of God
And all our sorrows fade

C. Memorizing quotations

The ideas below will help you introduce the quotation that the children will commit to memory in this final lesson, which is focused on the theme of steadfastness.

> One of the most important qualities of a person who truly loves God is steadfastness. No matter what happens in life, we always remember God and our love for Him. Therefore, nothing that others can say or do to us can affect our faith in Him. We love Him and obey His laws and teachings. To remind us that we should remain steadfast at all times, let us memorize the following quotation of Bahá'u'lláh:
>
> **"Supremely lofty will be thy station, if thou remainest steadfast in the Cause of thy Lord."[127]**

Supremely

1. The gardens were more beautiful than any Xavier had ever seen. He could not imagine a garden more supremely beautiful.

2. Keletso's mother made a very special cake for the family. They ate it with great enjoyment, and all said it was supremely delicious.

Lofty

1. Each night before she sleeps Martha prays and feels close to God. When she goes to sleep her spirit is in a lofty state.

2. At the meeting, Kumar gave a talk about world peace and the goodness of humanity. Kumar spoke about lofty ideas.

Remain steadfast

1. Rosemary's friend keeps telling her that stars are little lamps floating in the sky. But Rosemary learned in class that each star is really a faraway sun. Rosemary does not change her mind. She remains steadfast in what she knows to be true.

2. Someone told Mona that it is not important to pray every day, but she kept praying because she knew it was a law of God to pray. Mona remained steadfast in following the law of prayer.

D. Story

Perhaps you know that Bahíyyih Khánum was the younger sister of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. She was around six years old when their Father, Bahá'u'lláh, was arrested and sent to prison by an unjust government. You remember from another story that her family was part of the nobility. But, upon her Father's arrest, all of the family's possessions were taken away. Their lands, their houses, their furniture, their belongings—these were all gone. The family was left with almost nothing, not even food to eat. When she and her beloved older Brother, 'Abdu'l-Bahá, were hungry and there was no bread to give them, their mother poured some flour into the palms of their hands for them to eat instead.

After a time, their Father was released and forced by the government to leave their homeland. Bahíyyih Khánum and her family then set out in the bitter cold of winter for the city of Baghdád in a neighboring country. To reach the city, they had to cross huge, snow-covered mountains. The journey was perilous, and the supplies they had for the trip were not adequate. Their clothing did little to protect them from the snow and cold. With the help of only some mules, they slowly made their way along the high peaks of the mountains. Often, they had to make camp for the night in the total wilderness. But God protected them, and through His unfailing assistance, they arrived safely in Baghdád after three months. Never again would Bahíyyih Khánum return to the land of her birth.

For the rest of her life, Bahíyyih Khánum shared in her Father's sufferings and exiles. Eventually, the government banished Bahá'u'lláh to the prison-city of 'Akká, where she and her family lived among the most unwanted criminals. When the Father she loved so dearly departed this world, Bahíyyih Khánum faithfully supported her beloved Brother, 'Abdu'l-Bahá, Who had been appointed the Head of His Father's Faith. And, many years later, when 'Abdu'l-Bahá, too, passed into the next world, Bahíyyih Khánum became the greatest supporter and staunchest defender of His grandson, young Shoghi Effendi, who had been named the Guardian of the Faith by 'Abdu'l-Bahá.

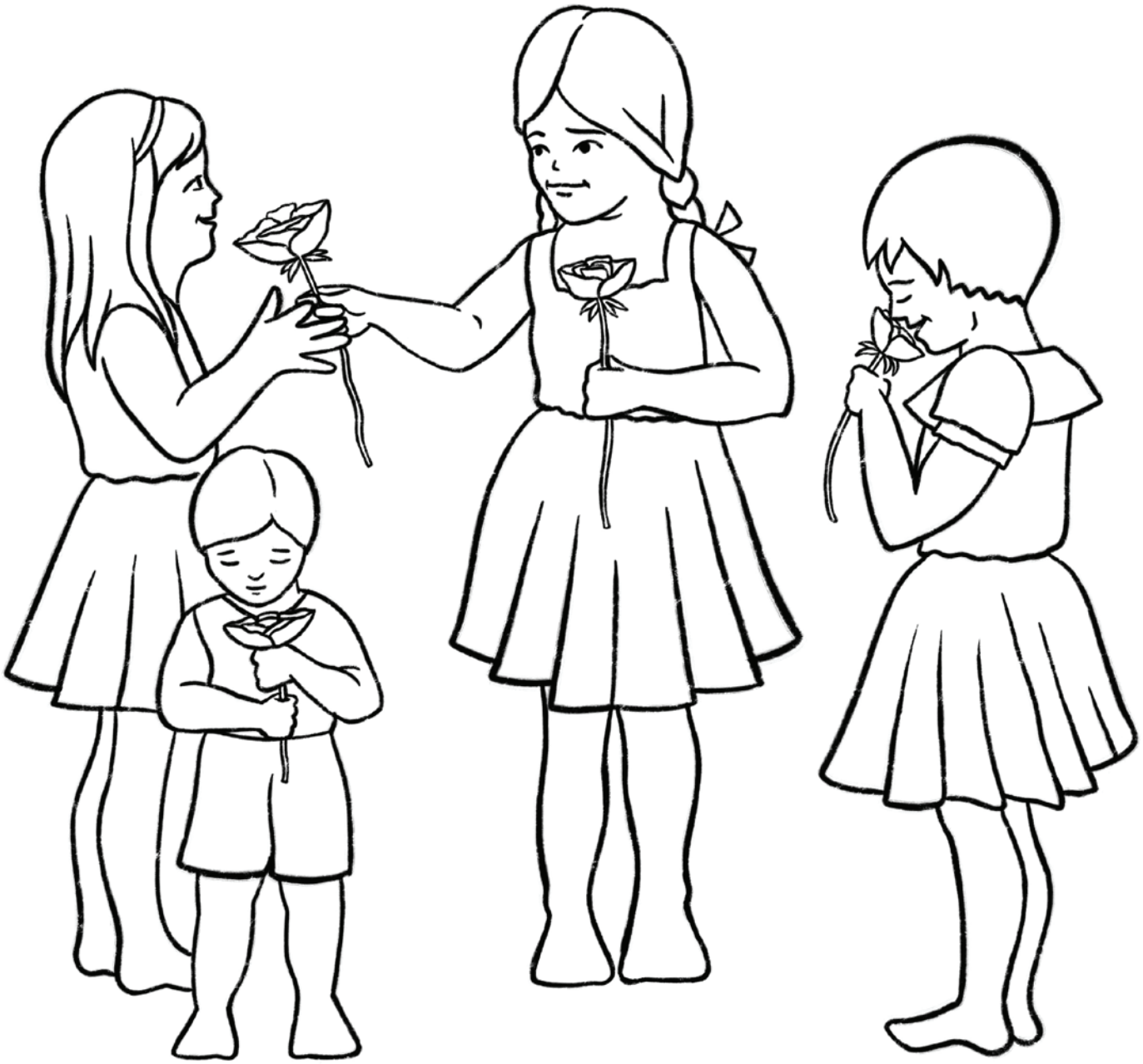
Bahíyyih Khánum was now an old woman. Her life had been filled with turmoil and upheaval. It moved from hardship to hardship, from calamity to calamity. But her spirit remained constant, and her heart was always filled with the love of God. She was steadfast and firm through the final days of her life.

E. Game: "A Helping Hand"

Ask the children to form pairs and hold hands with their partner. First have them walk around the area in pairs, with their eyes open. They should begin with tiny steps, and their steps should gradually become longer and longer. Each pair should take care not to bump into anyone. Then, one partner in each pair should shut his or her eyes, and they should repeat the walking exercise. Now if they are to avoid bumping into anyone, the other child will need to guide his or her friend. Tell them they must use signals given by touch alone. You should help them devise the signals before they start—for example, one squeeze of the hand could mean "stop", two "go back", three "turn right", and four "turn left".

F. Coloring: Drawing 24

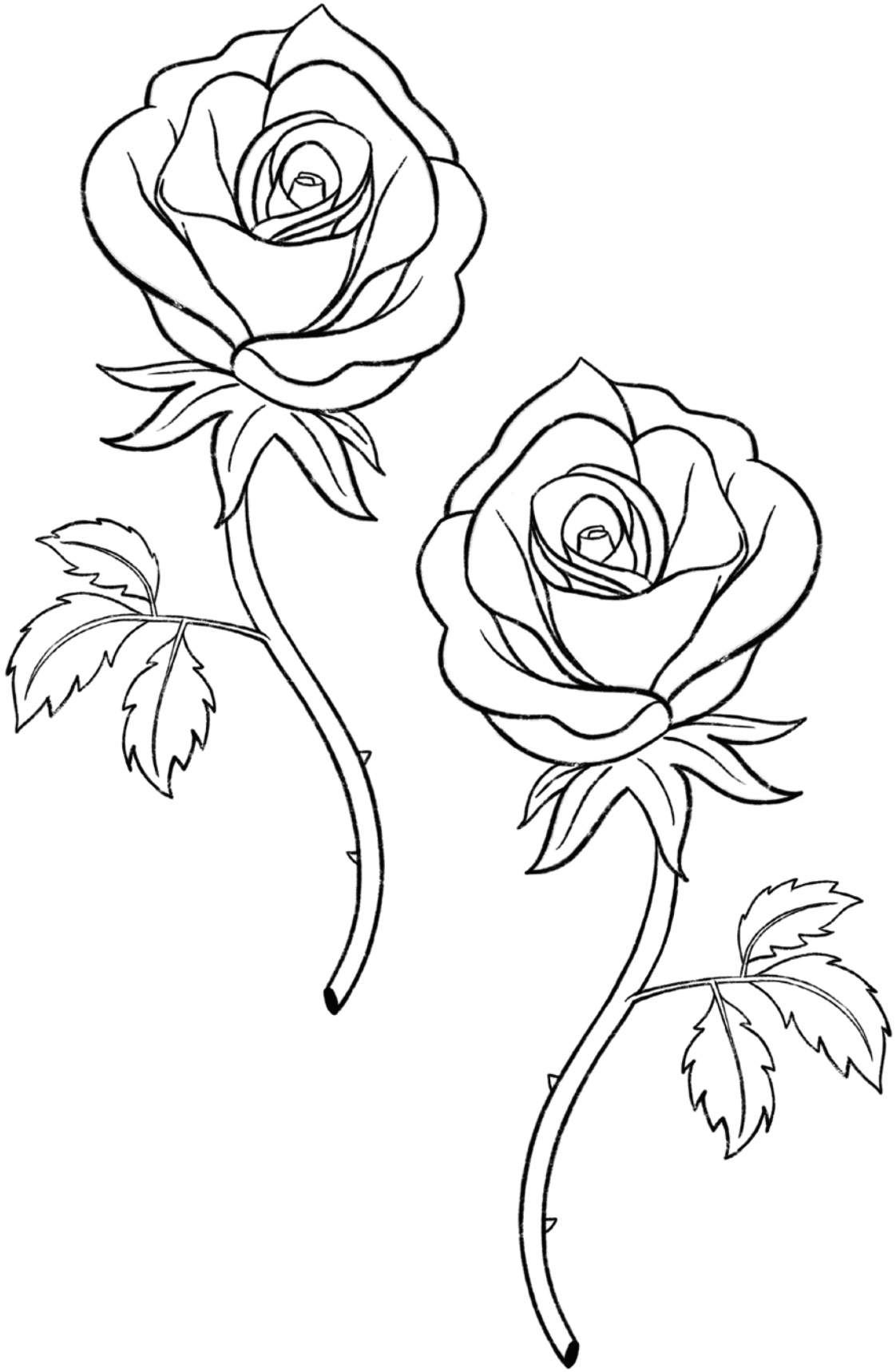
G. Closing prayers



“O Son of Spirit! My first counsel is this: Possess a pure, kindly and radiant heart . . .”



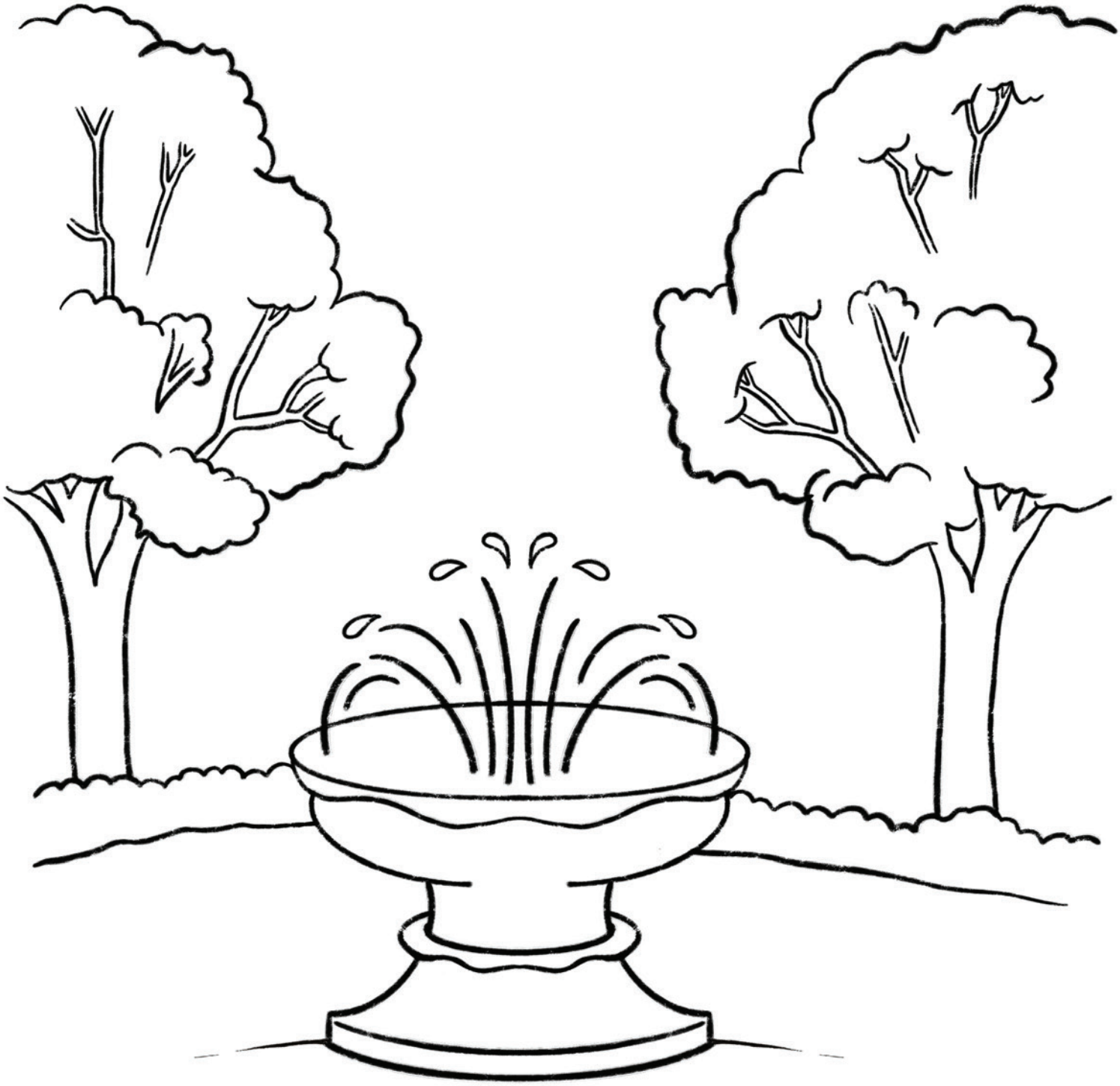
“Tread ye the path of justice, for this, verily, is the straight path.”



“O Friend! In the garden of thy heart plant naught but the rose of love . . .”



“Truthfulness is the foundation of all human virtues.”



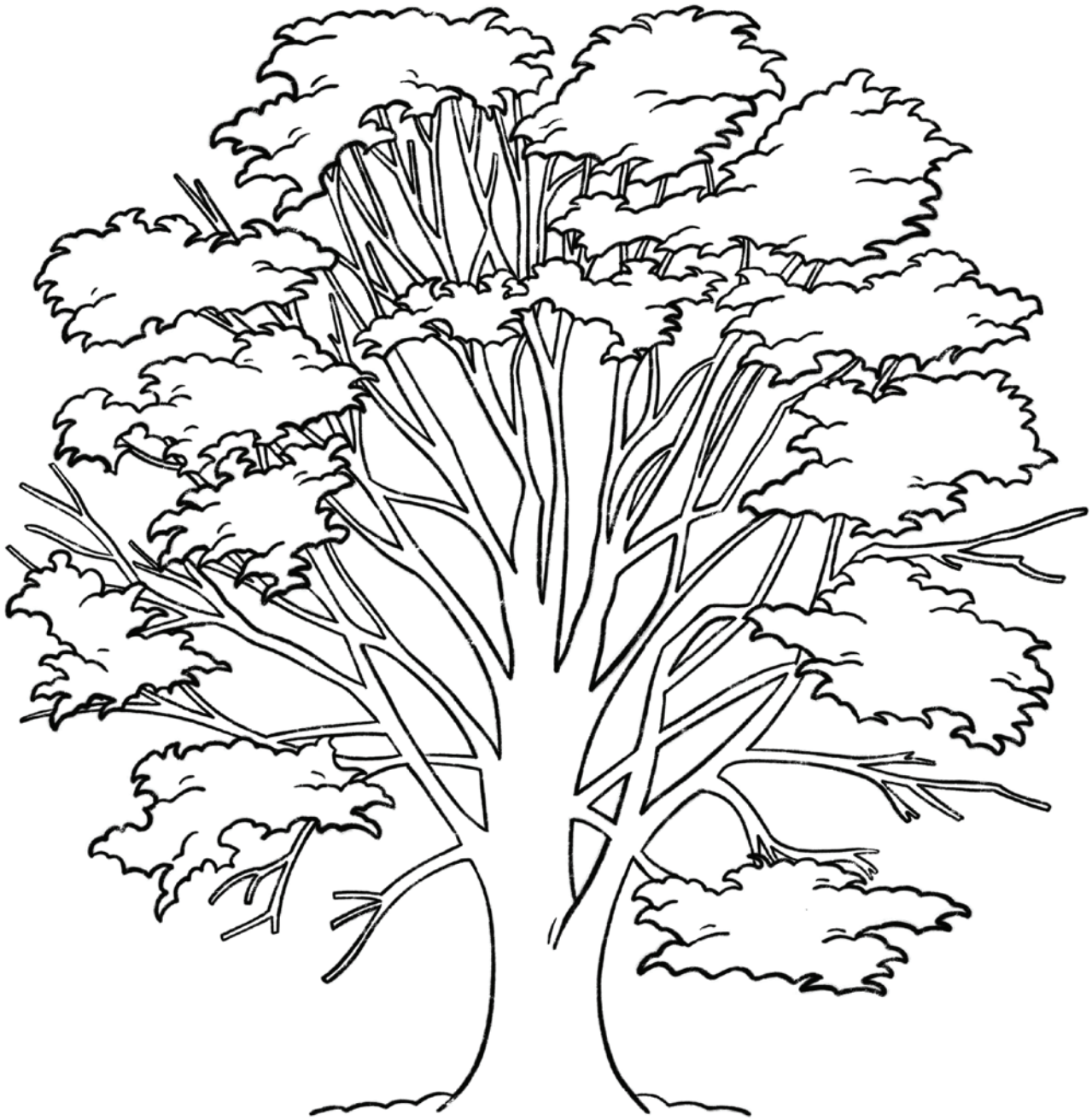
“To give and to be generous are attributes of Mine; well is it with him that adorneth himself with My virtues.”



“Blessed is he who preferreth his brother before himself.”



“O Son of Man! Rejoice in the gladness of thine heart, that thou mayest be worthy to meet Me and to mirror forth My beauty.”



“We should at all times manifest our truthfulness and sincerity . . .”



“O Son of Man! Humble thyself before Me, that I may graciously visit thee.”



“Be thou happy. Be thou grateful. Arise to render thanks unto God, that thy thankfulness may conduce to an increase of bounty.”



“. . . let your adorning be forgiveness and mercy and that which cheereth the hearts of the well-favored of God.”



**“Beautify your tongues, O people, with truthfulness,
and adorn your souls with the ornament of honesty.”**



“The Kingdom of God is founded upon equity and justice, and also upon mercy, compassion, and kindness to every living soul.”



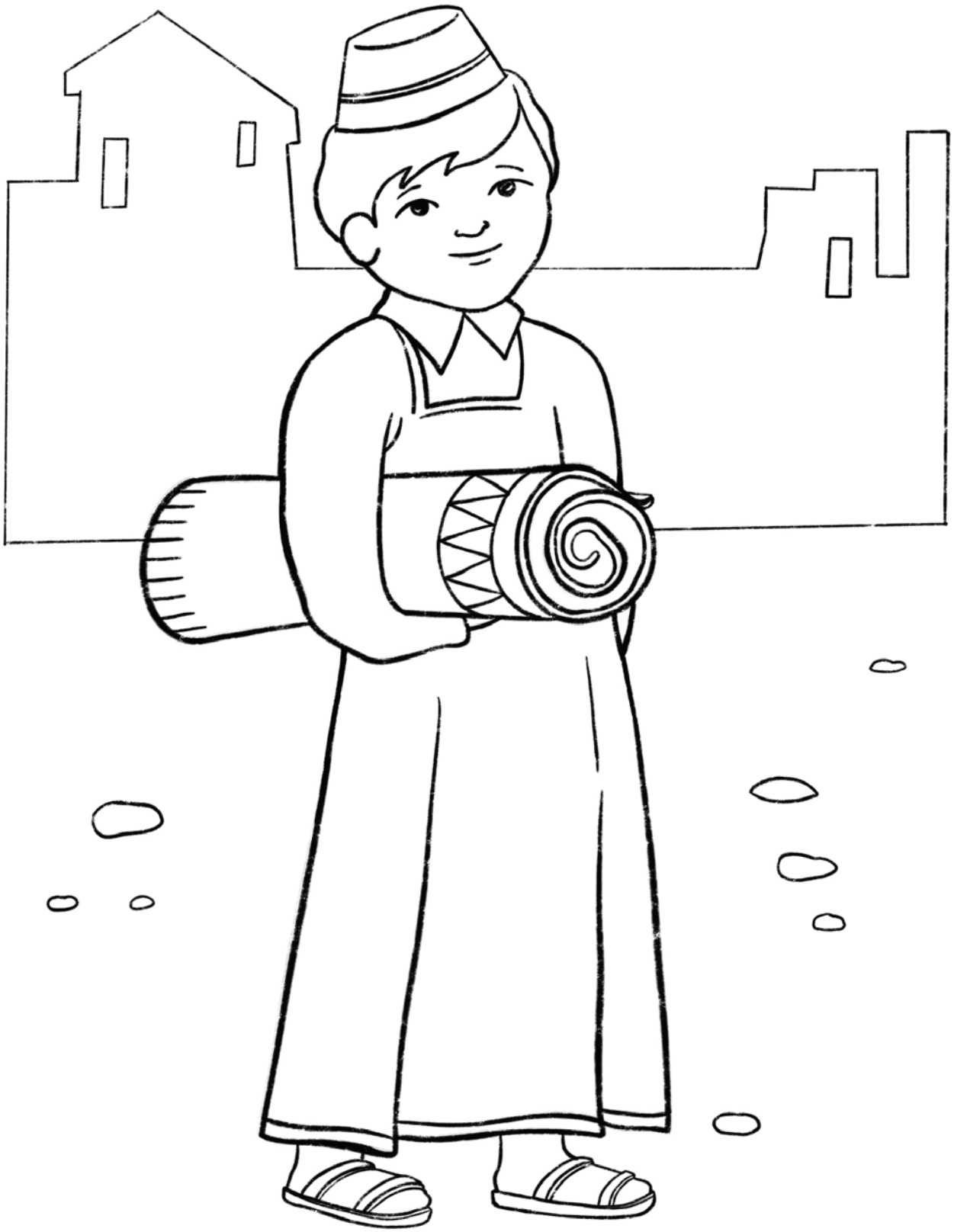
“Know that thy true adornment consisteth in the love of God and in thy detachment from all save Him . . .”



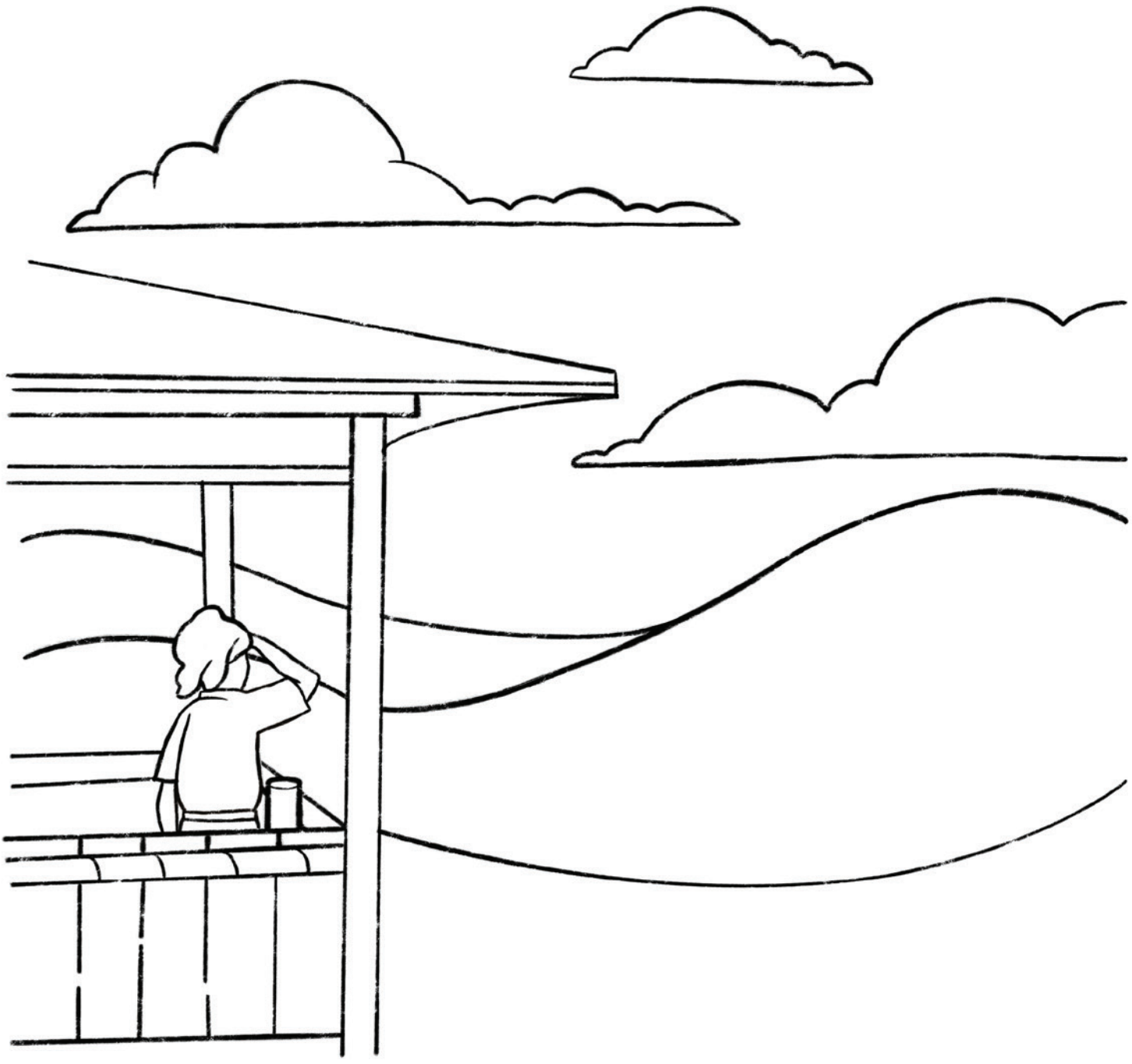
“The source of all glory is acceptance of whatsoever the Lord hath bestowed, and contentment with that which God hath ordained.”



“Blessed is he who mingleth with all men in a spirit of utmost kindliness and love.”



“The source of courage and power is the promotion of the Word of God, and steadfastness in His Love.”



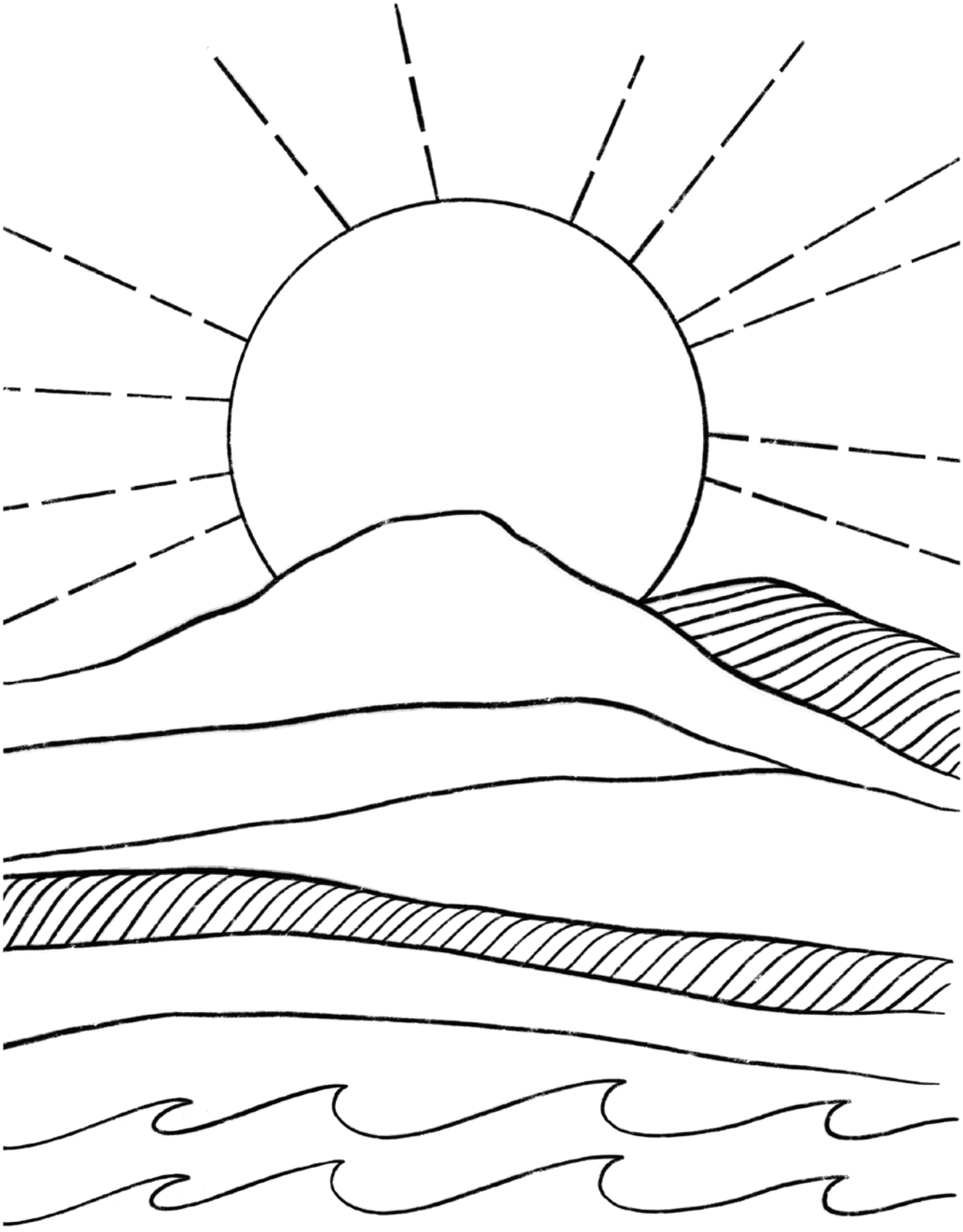
**“Never lose thy trust in God. Be thou ever hopeful,
for the bounties of God never cease to flow upon man.”**



“Trustworthiness is the greatest portal leading unto the tranquility and security of the people.”



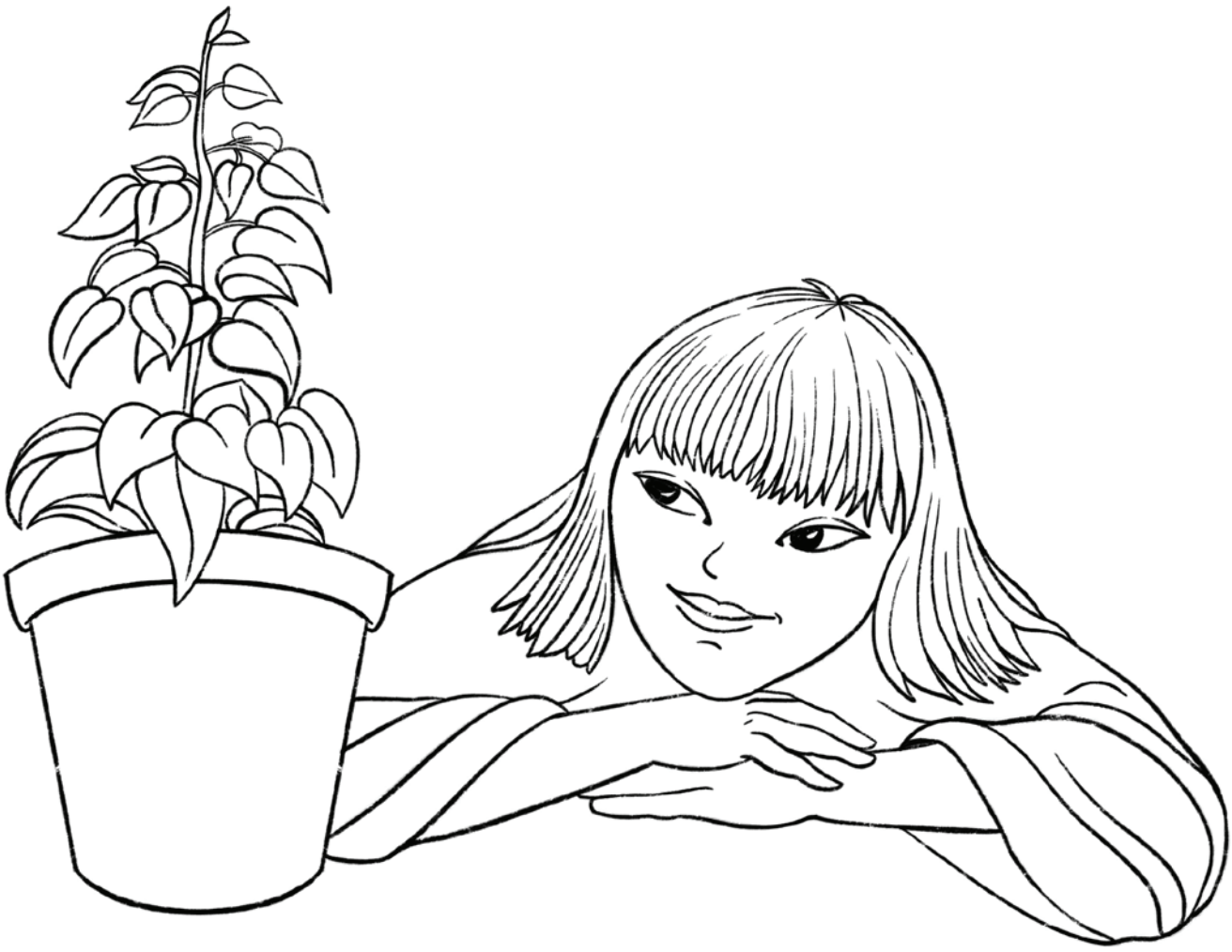
**“Be ye enkindled, O people, with the heat of the love of God,
that ye may enkindle the hearts of others.”**



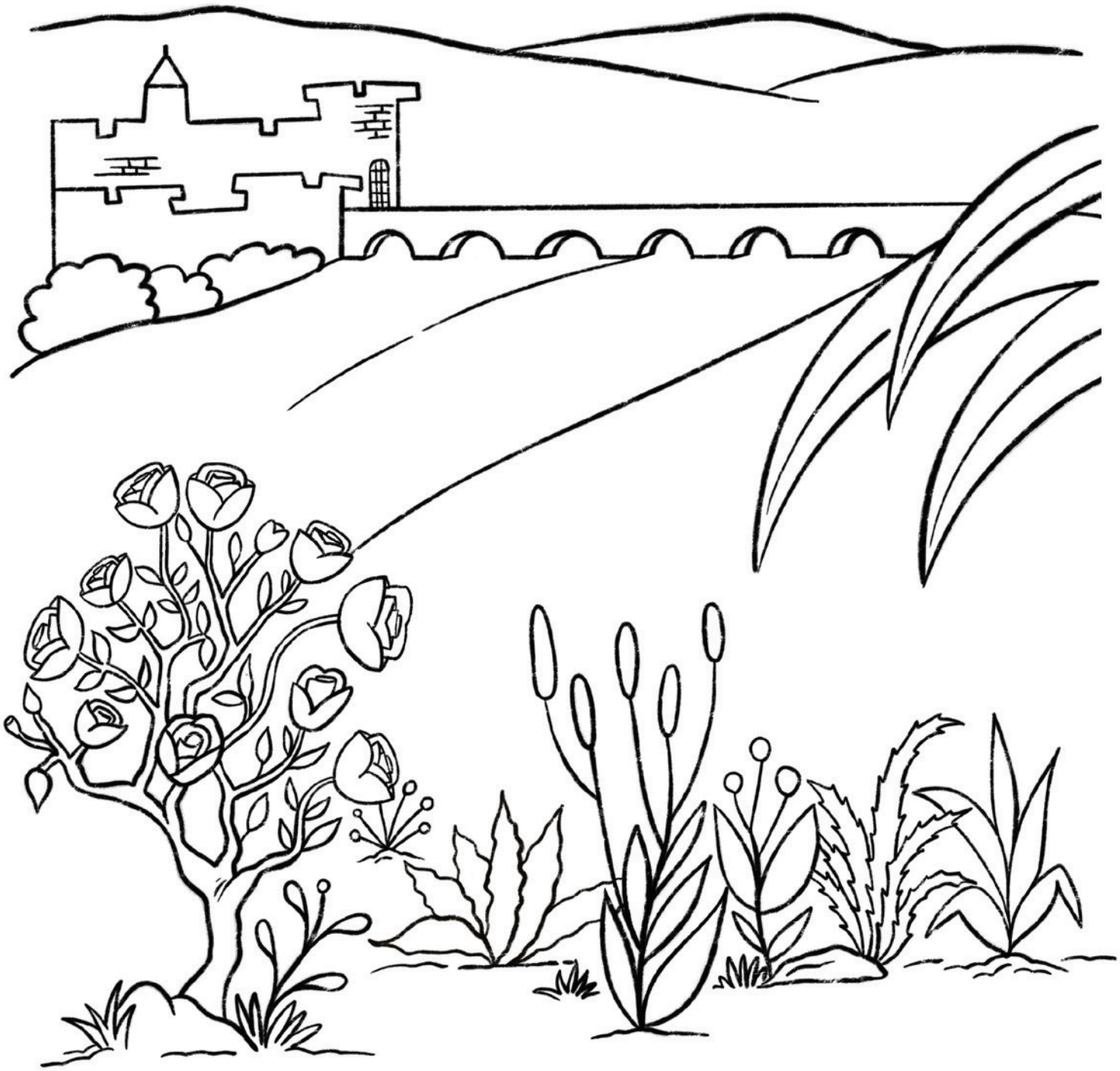
**“O Son of Being! Thou art My lamp and My light is in thee.
Get thou from it thy radiance and seek none other than Me.”**



“Happy is the faithful one who is attired with the vesture of high endeavor and hath arisen to serve this Cause.”



“He, verily, shall increase the reward of them that endure with patience.”



“Supremely lofty will be thy station,
if thou remainest steadfast in the Cause of thy Lord.”